



HUMAN RESOURCE POLICY DOCUMENT

2025

AKUAPEM RURAL BANK HUMAN RESOURCE POLICY MANUAL

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Revision History

Version	Date	Revision Author	Summary of Changes

Key definitions

Manual	A policy and procedure manual is the functional guide for conducting the operations of the Bank and employees. It lays foundation to the decisions and procedures for the day to day running of the Bank and sets out the modalities in the employment of staff, their rights and obligations.
Policy	A definite course or method of action to guide and determine present and future decisions. A policy is a guide to decision-making under a given set of circumstances within the framework of the corporate objectives, goals and management philosophies.
Procedure	A particular way of accomplishing the task, or an established way of doing things. A procedure is a series of steps followed in a definite regular order that ensure a consistent and repetitive approach to actions.
HOD	Head of Department
BM	Branch Managers

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HR POLICY AND PROCEDURE MANUAL

PURPOSE AND INTENT

1.0 INTRODUCTION

POLICY STATEMENT

This manual is intended to be a source of information for the Human Resources Department to guide Management and Staff of Akuapem Rural Bank Plc on matters of general policy and procedures with the view to achieving uniformity and clarity in managing the Human Resource of The Bank. The content of this document establishes the framework within which the Conditions of Service of The Bank for Management, Senior and Junior Staff are implemented.

The provisions contained herein do not absolve staff from their responsibility for observance of the rules and regulations pertaining to the laws of Ghana. Unless otherwise stated, the provisions in this manual apply to all departments of The Bank.

The manual establishes relationship, commitments and obligations of The Bank to the staff and vice-versa.

Policies will remain in effect until reviewed. New policies or policy changes are effective as of the date indicated on the policy page. Any changes/amendments to this policy will be published and circulated to all staff and deemed to be part of this policy document. The Policy will apply to all staff except when indications on applicability are stated.

It is expected that each staff study, understand and get acquainted with all the provisions stated therein. It is worthy of note that ignorance of the provisions in this manual shall not be an excuse in any disciplinary action against any staff.

It is acknowledged that Human Resources issues shall arise which may

not be covered by the provisions of this manual. In such circumstances, professional judgment of the Management Committee shall be essential in making recommendations to the Board for consideration and implementation.

1.1 CORPORATE VALUES

RESPONSIVENESS

To meet the ever-changing needs of our clients and communities.

HONESTY

To be transparent and trustworthy in our operations.

DEPENDABILITY

To be reliable and consistent in our service delivery.

MOTIVATION

To boost the morale of staff by rewarding them for effective, excellent and timely performance.

To create an environment that allows individual staff to use their initiative.

1.2 SOURCE DOCUMENTS

This manual has been documented with reference to, and in alignment with the following documents

- * Labour Act, 2003 (Act 651)
- * Labour Regulations, 2007 (LI. 1833)
- * Workmen Compensation Act, 1987 (PNDCL 187)
- * Collective Bargaining Agreements
- National Pensions Act, 2008 Act 766
- Offices and Shops Act, 1970 (Act 328)

1.3 RULES AND REGULATIONS OF AKUAPEM RURAL BANK PLC

The Company Rules and Regulation section clarifies the standards of behaviour that are expected of ARB staff in the performance of their duties. It gives guidance in areas where staff needs to make business, personal and ethical decisions.

Staff Oath of Secrecy

General Standards of Conduct

- Conflict of interest
- Withdrawal of salaries
- Overdrawing of staff account
- Non-solicitation guidelines

Code of Conduct – Outside Activity
Code of Conduct – Political Activity
Code of Conduct – Behavior During ARB- Sponsored Training
Code of Conduct – Use of Company Property
Code of Conduct – Dating in the Workplace
Dress code
Electronic media policy
Patents and Copyrights

General standard of conduct

Introduction: All persons employed by or associated with The Bank are expected to deal honestly, truthfully and fairly with others in business. False or intentionally misleading statements or omissions of any kind should never be made. Akuapem Rural Bank will not tolerate any type of deceitful practices.

Policy

Ensuring that Bank staff adhere to ethical standards that enhance our corporate image and fosters public trust in the impartiality and integrity of ARB's services and to avoid all appearances of conflicts of interest.

Definitions

Conflict of interest exists where there is an actual or perceived incompatibility between a staff's duties and responsibilities of office and the private interests of the staff or an immediate family member which can include but is not limited to pecuniary interests including investments and business involvements; outside employment; service, whether voluntary or otherwise, on a board, council or committee or other organization; and personal relationships, including immediate family and spouse.

Guidelines

- a. Staff are not prevented from using Bank information that is available to the public in the management of their private affairs. However, where such information is not available to the public, staff must manage their private affairs so that neither they nor their immediate family, relatives, friends, current or former business associates benefit from the use of such information. Staff are responsible for making sure there are no conflicts of interest.

- b. Staff shall disclose and discuss with the Head of HR, any situation, which may be a conflict of interest.
- c. Staff are forbidden to make personal representation to the members of the Board of Directors without prior approval from Management.
- d. No staff shall accept from any customer a gift or remuneration of any description whether in money or in kind;
- e. No staff is permitted to derive any benefit in the course of his official duties which might have the effect of placing him in such a position that his personal interest and his duties to the Bank or to any customer of the Bank would be in conflict and he shall refrain from taking any course of action which might place him in such a position.
- f. No staff shall borrow money from or in any way place himself under a pecuniary obligation to a money lender or a staff of the Bank or person having dealings with the Bank;
- g. A Staff shall not lend money in his private capacity to a customer or staff of the Bank;
- h. Except with the written permission of the CEO, staff shall not guarantee in his private capacity the pecuniary obligations of another person or agree to indemnify in such capacity another person from loss;
- i. No staff shall engage in any transaction or do any act, which might reflect on his integrity as a servant of the Bank;
- j. Except with the written consent of the CEO, staff shall not accept Office on a Municipal Council, in Parliament, any Company or Enterprise of Public Board or Corporation where his services will be required during normal working hours;
- k. Staff, found guilty of infringing any of these provisions shall render himself liable to immediate dismissal from the service of the Bank;
- l. Complaints from the public about staff' conflicts of interest (i.e., outside activities) will be referred to the Head of HR for further action/investigation.

Withdrawal of Salaries

A staff shall not draw his/her salary in advance without the pre-approval, in writing, by the CEO or a staff authorized by the CEO to give such approval.

Overdrawing of Staff Accounts

Staff who overdraws on his/her Bank Accounts renders his/herself liable to disciplinary sanctions from the Bank.

Non-Solicitation Guidelines

For reasons of safety and privacy, staff are prohibited from soliciting for any outside activity or organization during work hours unless the

solicitation is approved by the Bank and is in accordance with the requirements and restrictions of this policy.

The Bank defines solicitation as including verbal or written communication, raffle tickets, for sale merchandise, e-mail, distributions, circulars, handbills, or other kinds of literature.

Furthermore, staff should not use **AKUAPEM RURAL BANK** computer and communication systems and materials – including inter-department mail, e-mail, telephone, or other related workplace equipment – for any purposes not directly related to workplace business and/or activities without the expressed approval of Departmental/Unit Head.

1.4 AMENDMENTS

This policy shall be reviewed every 2 years except when majority of the sections becomes obsolete due to the repeal of sections of the Labour Act or any of the fundamental enactments used in the drafting of this policy.

2.0 GENERAL PROVISIONS

2.1 EMPLOYMENT TERMS AND CONDITION POLICY

2.2 AIM

To provide clear and transparent terms and conditions of employment which are in tandem with all legal requirements.

2.3 POLICY

Given below are the terms and conditions of employment provided for all employees. All queries at variance with this policy are to be addressed to the Human Resource Department.

2.4 APPOINTMENT

The following documentation is required before the appointment of a person as a member of staff of Akuapem Rural Bank Plc:

- Application letter

- Curriculum Vitae
- Police Background checks
- Two Passport pictures
- Confidential Report from Previous Employer
- Valid Identity Card (Ghana Card)
- Verification of Certificates
- Medical Report
- Credit Bureau Reference
- Referencing from Referees⁴⁴⁴
- Clearance from Bank of Ghana before confirmation

2.4.1 INTERVIEWS

The following pass marks shall apply:

Main interview for Employment – 60%

Promotional Interview – 70%

2.5 CLASSIFICATION OF EMPLOYEES

All employees in the Bank shall be classified under the following:

- **PERMANENT EMPLOYEE**

Is one who is employed at a permanent post and includes any person who has satisfactorily completed the prescribed period of probation in the same or higher or equivalent category in the Bank and has been confirmed in writing.

- **TRAINEE**

Is one who is engaged essentially in acquiring the skill sets required for the job assigned to them, provided that the period of such learning shall not exceed six (6) months.

- **CONTRACT EMPLOYEE**

Is one who is engaged to work for a definite period of time on a specific project or set of tasks.

2.5.1 PROOF OF AGE

Every employee at the time of their employment shall be required to declare their age in the personal data form. Every employee for this purpose shall provide a Birth certificate issued by the Registrar of Births and Deaths as proof of age. The Birth Certificate, Ecowas Identity Card or the Weighing Card of an employee's child shall also be provided as proof of age.

2.5.2 PROOF OF IDENTITY

Every employee at the time of their employment shall be required to submit a copy of their Ecowas Identity Card as proof of Identity.

2.5.3 PROOF OF ADDRESS

- a) All employees shall provide proof of permanent/temporary address and phone number(s), and email address upon joining the Bank and all written correspondence wherein there is need to be addressed to the employee's residence, shall be sent to the last residential and email address provided by the employee and any correspondence sent to the addresses given shall be deemed to have been served on the employee.
- b) When an employee is moving or relocating his residence, he shall provide the new address in writing one (1) week prior to his moving or relocating to the HR department.
- c) Employee(s) for this purpose shall provide any documents for proof of this address.

2.5.4 HOURS OF WORK

- a) The Bank's normal working hours shall be eight (8) hours per day forty (40) hours per week. Work starts from 8.00 am and ends at 5:00pm Monday to Friday with one hour lunch break each day between 12:00 pm and 2:00pm. The Bank reserves the right to require employees to work outside the normal working hours.
- b) Certain category of employees shall be required to work special hours based on the nature of their work.

2.5.5 ATTENDANCE

An employee who comes to work late for five (5) times within the month shall be sanctioned in accordance with the sanctions prescribed in this Policy.

ABSENTEEISM

- a) Staff shall not be absent from duties without having first obtained permission from Management or any other person authorized to grant such leave of absence.
- b) Staff absenting him/herself or overstaying his/her leave shall be warned in writing and/or be liable to deprivation of salary for the period of absence unless he/she is able to satisfy Management that unavoidable circumstances prevented him/her from obtaining permission or notifying the Bank of said absence.

- c) Any staff having been warned for irregular attendance shall render him/herself liable to disciplinary action.

VACATION OF POST

- a) A staff who is absent from work or overstays his/her leave without permission for ten (10) consecutive working days is considered to have resigned from employment without notice. Correspondence to this effect will be sent to his/her last known address by the Head, Human Resources who shall inform Management of the action taken. The staff will be liable to pay:
 - a) Key management Personnel: Three months of salary in lieu of notice
 - b) All other staff: one month salary in lieu of notice
- b) Staff terminated for vacation of post may appeal to management and if Management is satisfied that unavoidable circumstances prevented him/her from returning to duty or notifying management of absence, may, at its discretion, reinstate staff into service.

2.5.6 USE OF IDENTITY (ID) CARDS

- a) Every employee shall be provided with an identity card (ID) which shall contain the employee's particulars. This ID card is given for:

IDENTIFICATION OF THE EMPLOYEE

EMERGENCY CONTACT

- b) The employee shall carry their staff ID card on themselves visibly at all times within the Bank.
- c) The staff ID cards shall be the property of the Bank and should be surrendered to the HR department on cessation of employment.
- d) Under no circumstance should any employee relinquish possession of their ID card to anyone except an officer in the Human Resource Department of the Bank or the C.E.O.
- e) Loss or damage of the ID card should be reported immediately to the HR Department for replacement.

- f) If the employee loses or damages her ID card once, it will be replaced by management for free. However, on the second occasion onwards, the employee would be debited for the replacement of the ID card.
- g) On no occasion shall an employee use another employee's ID card **for any purpose whatsoever**

2.6. INTER AND INTRA DEPARTMENTAL COOPERATION

- a) Every employee must seek to clearly understand what his individual and team objectives are and how they fit into the wider objectives of the Bank.
- b) Effective communication between employees in a department or Unit whose activities impact those in other Departments or Units and which affects the service provision of the Bank must be ensured. This is to enable employees work together

as competent, committed and capable teams/units, whose individual and team objectives are synchronized with the Bank's strategic goals and objectives.

2.7 INTERNAL RELATIONS.

- a) Employees should be considered to have equal rights and responsibilities as required by the laws of Ghana. There should therefore be no favoritism of any kind shown to any individual by reason of their sex, race, tribe, religion or any other affiliation when it comes to promotion or appraisal.
- b) Employees should treat co-employees with all the respect, support and attention they deserve especially when it comes to meeting their requests for information, documents, resources and any input they require to carry out their duties/tasks in a timely manner.
- c) Employees should endeavor not to do anything that is detrimental to their relationship with their colleagues, superiors and subordinates. In this regard, good interpersonal skills must be exhibited in all dealings with other employees.

2.8 GUIDELINES ON PERSONAL CONDUCT

DRESS CODE

Introduction: Proper grooming and attire have a positive impact on the workplace.

Dress and grooming of staff shall be clean, neat, and in a manner appropriate to their assignment

Policy

ARB staff must at all times project a professional image/appearance which would not be distracting to coworkers and would also ensure public respect in The Bank

Guidelines

All staff are expected to dress in a way that projects a good public image of the Bank at all times. Appearance and etiquette must convey a sense of confidence and professionalism. Uniformed staff are expected to wear the daily designated attire at all times during working hours.

- a. Staff supplied with corporate clothing are required to wear the clothing whilst undertaking official duties.
- b. Clothing must be kept tidy and clean, and complement good personal grooming
- c. Staff must not alter the design, cut or pattern of the garments in any way

Appropriate Professional Attire for Male employees

- **Suits:** Dark colored suits; black, charcoal or dark grey.
- **Shirts:** White or blue shirts must be worn at all times. Bright colors such as green, purple, pink or orange etc. are not allowed.
- **Trousers:** Only dark colored trousers must be used at all times if not in a suit.
- **Shoes:** Dark shoes must be worn at all times
- **Grooming:** Beards, moustache, hair and any facial hairs should be kept neat and well-trimmed.
- Nails should be kept short
- **Friday Wear/Bank cloth Guidelines**
 - Long sleeve or short sleeve shirts
 - No embroidery
 - No trimmings
 - No additional fabrics to be used

Female employees

- **Suits:** Dark colored suits, business dresses, trouser suits, dress skirts and shirts
- **Shirts:** Ladies shirts must be plain in business colors such as blue, white, beige etc. No bright colors such as florescent green, bright orange, ultra violet purple, red or yellow are allowed. Overly patterned and floral outfits should also be avoided.
- **Shoes:** Shoes must be dark colored to match dark suits.
Please note that strappy shoes are not allowed.
- **Headgear:** No headgear is allowed
- **Hair dos:** No bright hair colors such as ginger, red etc. are allowed. Hair-dos must be kept professional

- **Nails:** Keep it short and simple
- **Jewelry:** Keep it professional
 - No nose studs
 - No Anklets
 - No extra earrings

Friday Wear/Bank cloth Guidelines:

- Slit and Kaba and dresses are allowed
- No strappy styles
- No sleeveless styles
- No low-cut styles (front/back)
- No trimmings
- No additional fabrics should be used with Friday wear
- No embroidery

All staff

- No slippers are allowed
- Trainers are not allowed with suit
- No chewing of gum at the front line
- Accessories should be kept at the barest minimum and should not detract from the professional image required of an ARB employee.
- Staff are expected to wear clean, non-faded, full-length jeans. Cut offs tatted jeans and capris are not allowed
- If for any reason any staff cannot dress as per the Tuesday to Friday wear guidelines, they should wear regular business attire as defined for male and female employees above.

Clothing that reveals cleavage, back, chest and/or stomach or underwear is not appropriate for a place of business.

- a. Clothing should be pressed and never wrinkled.
- b. Torn, dirty, or frayed clothing is unacceptable.
- c. All seams must be finished.
- d. Any clothing that has words, terms, or pictures that may be offensive to other staff or customers is unacceptable.

Dress code for employees:

DAY	MALE	FEMALE
Monday	Corporate Suit that includes (Black/Dark Blue /Grey) with White Shirt and Tie.	Corporate Suit that includes (Black/Dark Blue/Grey) Skirt or Trousers with White Inner.
Tuesday	Any other Corporate Suit with Blue Shirt and Tie. NOTE: (Hot colours like Red/Yellow/Green/Orange/ Pink are not accepted).	Any other Corporate Suit Trouser/Skirt/Dress with Blue Shirt. NOTE: (Hot colours like Red/Yellow/Green/Orange/ Pink are not accepted).
Wednesday	Any of the Bank's T-Shirt/Lacoste	Any of the Bank's T-shirt/Lacoste
Thursday	Any of the Bank's T-Shirt/Lacoste	Any of the Bank's T-shirt/Lacoste
Friday	Bank's Cloth	Bank's Cloth

Staff Responsibility

It is the responsibility of each staff to use good judgment and common sense in selecting clothing that fits with the function of his/her position and the professional image and mission of the Bank.

Supervisory Responsibility

Supervisors are responsible for ensuring that staff know, understand and adhere to this policy.

2.9.0 OTHER CODE OF CONDUCT

2.9.1 All employees of the Bank are expected to conduct themselves in a manner benefitting their position and status as employees of the Bank, and to carry out their duties and responsibilities promptly and efficiently. They are furthermore expected to take personal responsibility for their own conduct and behavior.

2.9.2 As part of the requirements of acceptable personal conduct, employees shall not engage in any of the offences/practices listed under Section 33.2 of this policy, and any others provided in other documents of the Bank.

2.9.3 Employees are expected to comply with the guidelines/directives in the Code of Conduct.

2.9.4 Entrance and exit from the premises shall be through prescribed gates only.

- 2.9.5** All employees bringing their own vehicles should properly park at the designated area to maximize parking space.
- 2.9.6** No non-Bank vehicle should be left overnight on the Bank's premises without approval from Management.
- 2.9.7** No employee shall take any paper, book, photograph, instrument, document or any other property of the Bank off the premises nor shall in any way pass, or cause to be passed or disclosed or cause to be disclosed, any information or matter concerning the operations of the Bank to any unauthorized person, company or corporation without the written permission of their immediate supervisor. If any employee is found doing so, he would be liable for disciplinary action.

2.10 GUIDELINES ON INTERNAL COMMUNICATIONS

- a) The Bank shall practice an open communications policy. This means that management shall endeavor to make employees fully aware of relevant matters concerning the progress/development of the Bank and the welfare of its employees.
- b) Notices to employees shall be posted on notice boards at each branch of the Bank, employee internal mails or on the A.R.B circular page.
- c) There shall be planned meetings and trainings etc. to disseminate useful information and other relevant statutory updates during the year.
- d) Heads of Departments and Branch Managers shall be required to circulate all relevant documents, including those on existing and new policies, regulations etc. to their subordinates on time.
- e) Depending on the level of seniority/grade of the recipient, all letters/correspondence on appointments/engagement, employee benefits,

disciplinary procedures and actions, transfers etc. shall be forwarded to employees only after the Head of Department or Branch Manager have been provided with prior information and have confirmed receipt of same before the employees can be furnished with the letter.

2.10.1 GUIDELINES ON EXTERNAL COMMUNICATIONS

- a) The Bank shall determine a specified medium for which information required by the general public shall be disseminated. Information to shareholders shall be determined by the Company Secretary's Office.

- b) No employee shall communicate any information gained in the course of his official duty either directly or indirectly with the electronic print media or any unauthorized person unless specifically authorized to do so.
- c) Any communication with the media/press shall go through the Chief Executive's Office.
- d) Employees shall not author anonymous publication in the form of letters, articles etc., or be party to any such publication. They shall furthermore not discuss any matter in any publication concerning the Bank and bearing their signature, in a manner calculated to undermine readers' confidence in the Bank.

2.11 CLEAN DESK POLICY

All employees shall endeavor not to leave any document on their desk after close of work and keep under lock and key all sensitive and confidential documents.

2.12 INTELLECTUAL PROPERTY RIGHTS

Any employee who develops either a template or an application or any other thing relevant to the operations of the Bank while in the employment of Akuapem Rural Bank shall not claim title to it. The Bank shall hold all intellectual property rights to it. However, the Bank shall pay or refund all incidental cost incurred during the development of the Application or Template. The Bank shall reward the employee to serve as a motivation to other staff for the growth of the Bank.

3.0 GENERAL PRINCIPLES OF RESPONSIBILITY AND ACCOUNTABILITY

- a) Authorization and approval shall be sufficient where given by a duly appointed authorizing officer or as delegated to another officer. This shall ensure that activities/transactions, especially those with financial implications are authorized and approved by designated officers within the scope and limit of their authority.
- b) Supervision of persons carrying out work is a necessity. This must involve checking work performed to ensure that employees discharge their duties as prescribed by their job schedule(s) given by their superiors and the Bank.

3.1.1 WORKING LANGUAGE

Documents emanating from the Bank shall be written in the official language of Ghana, namely English. Official texts and website information shall also be written in English.

3.1.2 CONFIDENTIALITY

ARB staff have a duty of loyalty to ARB as their employer. The duty of loyalty, affirmed through the Oath of Secrecy, requires staff to serve ARB to the best of their ability.

The release of confidential information that staff receive through the course of their employment may have a significant impact on The Bank's ability to manage its affairs or to maintain a perception of impartiality and integrity with its clients and the public.

To protect the interests of The Bank, its clients and the public, confidential information that staff receive through their employment must not be

divulged to anyone other than persons who are authorized to receive the information. Neither ex nor current staff can use confidential information, or

their ability to access such information, for the purpose of furthering any private interest or as a means of making personal gains. Confidential information covered under this bond include:

- a) Information relating to members of The Bank
 - d) Collective Agreements
 - e) Transactions, Proceedings and Decisions of the Board of Directors
 - f) Financial transactions of The Bank and its customers
 - g) Audit Inspection reports
 - h) Reports on all committees of enquiry and the disciplinary committee
 - i) General Committee reports
 - j) Information relating to personnel records on staff
 - k) Any other information which may lead to prejudice against The Bank and its stakeholders
-
- a) All employees of the Bank shall sign an Oath of secrecy at the beginning of every year and placed on the employees' file. The confidentiality requirement shall continue even after the employee has left the employment of the Bank.
 - b) Information, fact and/or inquiry considered confidential shall include any sensitive information, fact, and/or other clearly marked "confidential" and any other information and fact which by its nature can be considered or classified as confidential.
 - c) Management and staff of the Bank must ensure that data/information is handled in a manner that reduces the risk of misuse, lack of authorized use or disclosure of confidential information.

- d) No employee shall take any paper, book, photographs, instruments, documents or any other property of the Bank off the premises nor shall in any way pass, or cause to be passed or disclose or cause to be disclosed any information or matter

concerning the operations of the Bank to any organization or person, company or corporation without the written permission of the Chief Executive Officer.

- e) Employees given access to confidential information, data, business property, keys to premises or any other business-related property/information in the performance of their duties must ensure same is protected and used only in the interest of the Bank.
- f) Failure to comply with the Oath of Secrecy could result in disciplinary action up to and including dismissal. The Bank reserves the right to pursue monetary damages or similar remedies against the employee.
- g. In the case of a former staff, failure to comply with the Bond of Secrecy may result in legal action against the former staff.

3.1.3 CONFIDENTIALITY TALKING TO THE MEDIA

An employee shall obtain written permission from the Chief Executive Officer and/or the Company Secretary before making representations in the media either by appearing on television, radio, giving press interviews or participating in public discussions of any kind or contributing articles of any kind to the daily press or to any other publication.

4.0 INTERNET USE POLICY

The internet is provided by the Bank for business use. Limited private use is permitted if the private use does not interfere with a person's work and that inappropriate sites are not accessed e.g., pornographic, gambling sites. Management has the right to access the system to check if private use is excessive or inappropriate.

- a) Failure to comply with these instructions is an offence and will be subject to appropriate investigation. In serious cases, the penalty for an offence, or repetition

of an offence, may include dismissal. Staff need to be aware that some forms of internet conduct may lead to criminal prosecution.

4.1 EMAIL POLICY

- a) Email facilities are provided for formal business correspondence.
- b) Take care to maintain confidentiality of sensitive information. If emails need to be preserved, they should be backed up and stored offsite.
- c) Limited private use of email is allowed if it doesn't interfere with or distract from an employee's work.
- d) To protect the Bank from the potential effects of the misuse and abuse of email, the following instructions are for all users:
 - i) No material is to be sent as email that is defamatory, in breach of copyright or business confidentiality, or prejudicial to the good standing of the Bank in the community or to its relationship with staff, customers, suppliers and any other person or business with whom it has a relationship.
 - ii) Email must not contain material that amounts to gossip about colleagues or that could be offensive, demeaning, persistently irritating, threatening, and discriminatory, involves the harassment of others or concerns personal relationships.
 - iii) The email records of other persons are not to be accessed except by management (or persons authorized by management) ensuring compliance with this policy, or by authorized staff who have been requested to attend to a fault, upgrade or for similar situation. Access in each case will be limited to the minimum needed for the task.
 - iv) When using email, a person must not pretend to be another person or use another person's computer without permission.
 - v) Excessive private use, including mass mailing, "reply to all" etc. that are not part of the person's duties, is not permitted.
 - vi) Failure to comply with these instructions is a performance improvement offence and will be investigated. In serious cases, the penalty for breach of policy, or repetition of an offence, may include dismissal.

5.0 STAFF DURBAR

There shall be a Board/Staff durbar at least once in a year.

6.0 MANNER OF ENTRY AND EXIT

GIVEN BELOW ARE THE PROCEDURES FOR ENTRY AND EXIT FROM THE BANK PREMISES.

6.1 MOVEMENT OF EMPLOYEES

- a. Entrance and exit from the premises shall be through prescribed gates only.
- b. An employee who is not on duty shall not remain on the premises without permission from the manager or their authorized official.
- c. Visitors will be issued with an ID card, which should be returned when they leave the Bank's premises.
- d. Visitors entering the Bank must first be verified via the security desk to check if the person they wish to meet is available.
- e. The visitor is required to register at the security desk giving his/her name, phone number and ID number (Ecowas Card) and time of arrival.
- f. When leaving, the Visitor shall sign in the visitors register again at the security desk noting their time of exit before leaving the Bank's premises.

6.2 MOVEMENT OF VEHICLES

All employees bringing their own vehicles should properly park at the designated area to maximize parking space.

No non-Bank vehicle shall be left overnight on the Bank's premises without approval from Management.

7.0 COMPENSATION AND BENEFIT POLICY

7.1.0 Purpose

To provide the employees with the contractually agreed salary and benefit package as compensation.

7.1.1 POLICY

It is the policy of the Bank to pay employees by direct deposit into their staff Bank accounts on the agreed dates and in the agreed amount. Salary shall be for a period of one month and paid after one month of work or on pro-rata basis.

- a) The Board of Directors, upon the advice of Management shall determine salary levels.
- b) Employees would be entitled to a notch higher every year of their employment if they attain a pass mark of **75%** in the performance appraisals of the preceding year and subject to the approval of the Board.

7.2 PAYMENT OF SALARIES

- a) All employees shall be paid salaries based on the amount stated in their appointment letters including allowances as per their grade.
- b) Employees normally shall be paid on the nineteenth day of the month. If the regular payday occurs on a Saturday, Sunday, or a holiday, employees will be paid on the last working day before the regular payday.
- c) Employees on each payday will receive a statement showing gross pay, deductions, and net pay. Statutory deductions like Income tax and Social Security contributions shall be deducted automatically and paid to the appropriate agencies. No other deductions will be made unless it's in accordance with the law, contractual, or with the employees express consent. Employees may elect to have

additional voluntary deductions from their pay all such deductions must be authorized in writing.

- d) Employees should discuss any questions or concerns regarding their rate of pay and other compensation issues with their Departmental Heads and if not satisfied with the H. R. Department.

7.3 ALLOWANCES/BENEFITS

The following allowances shall be paid as per the Collective Bargaining Agreement for Junior Staff and Conditions of Service for Senior Staff:

- i. Out of Station
- ii. Overnight
- iii. Weekend

8.0 RELATIONSHIP POLICY

8.1 EMPLOYMENT OF IMMEDIATE RELATIVES

- a) Family relationship shall mean any relationship between two biological relatives, or related parties e.g., father and daughter, siblings, uncles and nephews/nieces, in-laws etc.
- b) Employees in family relationship shall not work in the same branch or department. In no circumstance shall an employee report directly to a relative.
- c) New hires are required to identify any potential conflict of interest during the recruitment process.

9.0 RENT ALLOWANCE

Employees shall be entitled to rent allowance

10.0 CLOTHING

All confirmed employees shall be entitled to 15% of their annual basic salary as clothing allowance which shall be paid at the beginning of every year or on pro rata basis dependent on when you were confirmed.

11.0 BONUS

The Board of Directors may declare bonuses from time to time, when such bonuses are declared individual payments shall be determined by the following criteria

- a) Bonus payment shall be paid based on appraisal of staff who exceeded set target and general performance of the Bank and appreciable profit declared. Bonuses would be prorated for staff who have less than one (1) year in the service of the Bank but exceeded set targets. However,

- b) when an employee spends more than eight (8) months in service and exceeded set targets he would be paid bonus as if he had served for a year.
- c) Bonus of Management members shall be determined by the Board in consultation with the CEO.
- d) All bonuses of staff who appear before the Disciplinary Committee will be withheld until a decision is made.
- e) After a decision is made and the staff's appointment is not terminated 5% of the bonus amount will be forfeited.
- f) Where the staff is exonerated of the offence, he/she shall be paid the full amount.
- g) In the event that the staff's appointment is terminated, he/she shall forfeit the entire bonus for the period.
- h) Staff who retire shall be entitled to the bonus accrued for payment for the particular year.
- i) Staff who resign from the Bank shall forfeit the bonus for that particular except where the staff has performed exceptionally.
- j) The payment of bonus to staff is not automatic but subject to the approval of the Board.

12.0 TRANSPORT

All staff are entitled to Transport subsidy at the prevailing fuel rate.

- a. Management and Senior Staff shall be entitled to fuel monthly paid on the 1st working day of the month. The value of the number of gallons shall be placed on a fuel card and uploaded monthly.
- b. Senior Staff who are pre-approved to conduct business of the Bank without using the banks vehicle may be entitled to additional gallons of fuel.
- c. Staff without personal vehicles shall be entitled to transport subsidy, which may be reviewed from time to time.

13.0 MEDICAL SCHEME

- a) An Employee, his registered spouse and three (3) registered children up to the age of Twenty-One (21) years who are not gainfully employed shall benefit from the Bank's medical scheme as follows:
 - i. Beneficiaries are required to attend Bank's designated medical facilities or Government hospitals.
 - ii. Bank shall approve medical claims for specialized attention if recommended by the Bank's Medical Doctor, any other registered Medical Doctor and a Traditional Herbalist registered and recognized by the Bank. The employee should seek permission from the HR department.

13.1 NHIS HEALTH SCHEME

1. Every Employee and his family shall be registered members of the National Health Insurance Scheme.
2. The Bank shall pay the NHIS registration and renewal fees for the Employee and his registered family where applicable.
3. It is the responsibility of the Employee to ensure that he and his family's NHIS status is always valid.

13.2 SPECTACLES

- i. The Bank shall refund the cost of new lenses purchased as well as replacement of lenses bought on medical prescription.
- ii. Upon presentation of satisfactory evidence, the Bank shall refund the cost of
- iii. replacement of an employee's spectacles or any part thereof damaged in the course of duty.
- iv. Spectacle frame is replaceable every two (2) years

14.0 FUNERAL GRANT

- a) In the event of the death of the spouse or child of an employee, the bank shall make a cash donation as prescribed by the Collective Bargaining Agreement
- b) In the event of the death of a parent of an employee, the bank shall make a cash donation as prescribed by the Collective Bargaining Agreement.
- c) In the case of a contract worker Management would contribute as per its discretion with approval from the Board.

14.1 POLICIES AND REGULATIONS FOR DEATH-IN-SERVICE

- a) On the death of an employee, the Bank shall provide cash donation of GH¢ 4,500 or as prescribed by the Collective Bargaining Agreement plus a coffin or shroud, a bottle of schnapps and transport to convey the corpse to the burial place.
- b) In the event of death, the salary due the employee shall cease at the end of the month in which he/she dies. Such payments and any other benefits which have accrued to the deceased

employee are payable to the spouse of the deceased or as prescribed by him/her in his/her will or declaration form.

- c) Where the employee has served a minimum of ten (10) years, ex-gratia at rates to be determined by the Bank shall be paid to his/her estate.
- d) In the event of the death of an employee, at least a Head of Department/ delegate shall attend the funeral celebrations and speak on behalf of the Department or the Bank.
- e) The Welfare Committee must ensure that a memorial service is arranged.
- f) HR and the committee shall organize a bus for all staff who will be attending the final funeral rites if the funeral is outside the ridge. Additionally, staff with Vehicles shall be encouraged to use their Vehicles to support in conveying colleagues to the funeral celebrations. Officials nominated to represent the Department/Bank at the memorial service/funeral celebrations will be required to submit the donations from the bank to the bereaved family.

14.2 ATTENDANCE

- a) Colleagues within the members' unit and other units are encouraged to attend the funeral.
- b) The Welfare Committee (WC) and HR should arrange transport for officials who shall represent Management at the funeral.
- c) A maximum of 5 Officials from the bank shall attend and be catered for by the Bank when a funeral of an employee is outside the Ridge.

15.0 PROVIDENT FUNDS (THIRD TIER OF PENSIONS ACT)

Every employee shall contribute to the provident fund scheme as provided by the scheme guidelines. Management in consultation with the Union shall form a committee to determine the operations and directions of the scheme. Employees may also contribute to the staff welfare scheme.

16.0 SPECIAL INCENTIVE

Long Service Award shall be awarded to staffs who have meritoriously served the Bank for 10yrs and above. However, the award shall be given to staff as it pertains in the Collective Bargaining Agreement.

17.0 OTHER ALLOWANCES

The following allowances shall be granted as per the Collective Bargaining Agreement for Junior Staff and Conditions of Service for Senior Staff:

I Out of Station

ii. Overnight

iii. Weekend

18.0 LOANS

The Bank may provide credit facilities to employees under terms decided by the Board to enable employees meet their financial requirements under the various types of loans within the scheme.
(See Akuapem Rural Bank Plc Staff Loan Scheme)

19.0 LEAVE POLICY

19.1 PURPOSE

To enable Akuapem Rural Bank Plc's employees to take time off for relaxation and to invigorate themselves.

19.2 GENERAL LEAVE POLICY

- a) Unless otherwise specified, employees referred to in this policy mean permanent or full-time employees.
- b) All planned leave must be mutually agreed, taking into consideration workloads and the employee's needs. Leave must be approved one week in advance, except where the employee cannot anticipate the absence. Any documents regarding leave will be kept on the employee's personal file.
- c) All employees shall make available to the Human Resource Department their expected leave dates for the following year and this leave roster shall be made available for Management's approval by 31 December of the preceding year.
- d) A copy of the leave roster shall be displayed conspicuously on the Staff Notice Board with a copy on file.
- e) An employee may resign while on leave, but they must give the required notice of resignation as set out in the appointment letter.
- f) Employees should not undertake any activity during leave which is inconsistent with the employment contract, including other employment.
- g) The employee's position may be filled on a temporary basis while they are on leave. The Bank will notify the replacement employee that their employment in this role is temporal.

h) Leave can also be taken based on the schedule by the Head of Department or as agreed with the Branch Manager or Head of Department.

i) Leave period for employees are as follows:

NO	CATEGORY	NO. OF DAYS ENTITLED
1	Heads of Departments	Thirty -Two (32) working days
2	Other Senior Officers	Thirty (30) working days
3	Junior Staff	Twenty-Eight (28) working days

j) Statutory holidays which occur during an employee's period of leave shall not be counted as working days.

k) Where it is not possible for an employee to take his annual leave at the scheduled time, it could be staggered or deferred but at the minimum every eligible employee must take 15 working days leave in a calendar year.

L) Where owing to exigencies of the service, the Bank is unable to permit an employee to take his/ her full leave entitlement in any particular year due to permission not granted by their BM or HOD, the portion which he/ she was unable to take shall be converted to cash and as such BM's and HOD's shall ensure staff deplete their leave days completely before the end of the eleventh month in the year.

No employee shall be permitted to accumulate leave. Unless otherwise agreed with their Head of department and approved by the HR Department, an employee who does not take his leave in the course of any particular year shall forfeit it.

l) An employee who overstays his leave except in circumstance beyond his control shall be liable to deprivation of salary for the period of absence without leave. In addition, other sanctions may be applied by Management. The onus of proof of the circumstance beyond control shall be that of the employee.

2. An employee on leave who is prevented by illness or injury from returning to duty must report this to his immediate supervisor within forty-eight (48) hours.

3. All employees including Agency Heads shall ensure that their duties including balancing of ledgers and returns are up to date before their leave requests are approved.

19.3 CASUAL LEAVE POLICY

An employee may be given casual leave for a maximum period of ten (10) working days in a year to attend to their urgent and important personal affairs at the discretion of the Bank.

Casual leave shall be applied for in writing and shall not be automatically granted.

19.4 SICK LEAVE POLICY

- I. An employee shall notify their BM/HOD within 24 hours if they are unable to attend work due to illness or injury. Management shall request a medical certificate in respect of their health status and their prospective return to duty as soon as possible.
- II. Sick leave with pay shall only be granted on the production of a Certificate signed by a certified medical doctor from a government hospital or the Bank's appointed Hospital.
- III. All employees shall be entitled to sick leave with pay as follows:

	FULL	HALF
Employees with at least six (6) months service but less than one (1) year service	4 weeks	4 weeks
Employees with one (1) year service but less than (5) years' service	3 months	3 months
Employees with five (5) years' service but less than ten (10) years' service	4 months	4 months
Employees with ten (10) years of service and over	6 months	6 months

Provided that in all cases, the grant of further periods of sick leave with pay after the maximum period described above shall be at the discretion of the Bank.

19.5 COMPASSIONATE LEAVE POLICY

Compassionate leave is paid leave taken by an employee to spend time with a family member/member of the employee's household, who has a personal illness, or injury, that poses a serious threat to his/her life, or after the death of a family member/member of the employee's

household. (Family member include: Father, mother, sister, brother, son, daughter, wife and husband)

Each employee is entitled to a period of three days paid compassionate leave for each occasion were a family member has died, or the employee needs to spend time with a seriously ill family member. Additional unpaid/paid leave maybe granted at Management's discretion.

Casual employees are entitled to three days' unpaid compassionate leave for each occasion.

19.6 MATERNITY LEAVE POLICY

- I. All female employees who are expecting a child are eligible for 12 weeks of paid maternity leave if they are permanent full-time employees of the Bank. Male employees shall be given a week of paid paternity leave if they are permanent full-time employees of the Bank.
- II. Female employees who are pregnant may commence leave up to six weeks before the expected date of confinement upon provision of a medical certificate by a certified medical practitioner stating expected delivery date.

19.7 TIME OFF FOR ANTENATAL APPOINTMENTS

Sick leave may be available for attendance of medical appointments. Appointment times and the availability of leave should be discussed with the immediate supervisor and they in turn will discuss it with the Head HR.

19.8 LEAVE FOR PREGNANCY RELATED ILLNESS

- I. If an employee is ill during her pregnancy, she may access her ordinary sick leave entitlements, including any accrued leave.
- II. If an employee experience extended illness due to pregnancy, she can access unpaid leave for the period her treating doctor certifies is necessary.

19.9 LOSS OF PREGNANCY

If the pregnancy ends within 28 weeks before the due date without a live birth, the employee may take sick leave for the period her treating doctor certifies is necessary. However, if she delivers the baby but does not get a live birth, the employee would be allowed a maximum leave of one month for normal birth and two months for caesarean birth.

19.10 LEAVE WITHOUT PAY POLICY

Leave without pay shall be at the discretion of the Board of Directors and determined by Management. An employee shall only apply after working with the Bank for a minimum period of two (2) years.

19.11 PATERNITY LEAVE

All male employees shall be entitled to five (5) working days paternity leave two (2) weeks before delivery or within three (3) months after delivery by their spouses.

20.0 OCCUPATIONAL HEALTH AND SAFETY POLICY

20.1 POLICY

- a) The Bank shall, as far as practicable, provide a safe work environment for the health, safety and welfare of its employees, contractors, visitors and customers who may be affected by its work.
- b) To do this, The Bank will:
 - I. Develop and maintain safe systems of work, and a safe working environment
 - II. Consult with employees and health and safety experts on safety
 - III. Provide information and training for employees on health and safety
 - IV. Assess all risks before work starts on new areas of operation, for example, buying new equipment and setting up new work methods, and regularly review these risks.
 - V. Remove unacceptable risks to safety
- c) Provide employees and contractors with adequate facilities (such as clean toilets, cool and clean drinking water, and hygienic eating areas)
- d) Ultimately, everyone at the workplace is responsible for ensuring health and safety at the workplace.
- e) All persons responsible for the work activities of other employees are also responsible for the identification of practices and conditions that could injure employees, customers, or the environment.
- f) Controlling such situations or removing the risk to safety. If unable to control such practices and conditions, report these to their manager.
- g) The Bank demands a positive, proactive attitude and performance with respect to protecting health, safety and the environment by all employees, irrespective of their position.

21.0 MANUAL HANDLING POLICY

- a) It is the Bank's policy to provide all employees with a safe and healthy workplace by identifying, assessing and controlling manual handling risks.
- b) While management is responsible for the health, safety and welfare of all staff, all employees must report potential and actual manual handling hazards.

- c) Never lift or manually handle items larger or heavier than you can easily support! If you are in any doubt, do not hesitate to ask for help.

22.0 INJURY PROCEDURE

- a) If there is an injury, the priority is medical attention. The injured worker or nearest colleague should contact one of the Bank's first aiders. For a serious injury the injured employee must be taken to Hospital immediately.
- b) Any employee who is injured on the job experiences a safety incident or a near miss, must report the incident to the BM/HOD and then it should be reported to the Human Resource Department.
- c) The BM must write a report in the Register of Injuries, Incidents and Near Misses. This standard report must include:
 - I. employee's name and job details
 - II. time and date of injury
 - III. exact location the injury/incident occurred
 - IV. how did the injury/incident happen
 - V. details of the injury/illness and the part/s of the body injured
 - VI. names of any witnesses
 - VII. name of the person entering details in the Register date the employer was notified
 - VIII. The Bank will acknowledge receipt of the report.

The BM must report serious injuries to the Human Resource Department immediately.

23.0 SMOKING POLICY

The Bank has a non-smoking policy. Smoking is not permitted on the Bank's property or in the offices at any time.

24.0 ALCOHOL & DRUGS POLICY

- a) The Bank is concerned by factors affecting an employee's ability to safely and effectively do their work to a satisfactory standard therefore the Bank shall do its utmost to create and maintain a safe, healthy and productive workplace for all employees.
- b) The Bank has a zero-tolerance policy with regards to the use of illicit drugs and alcohol on any of its premises. Contravening either of these points will lead to dismissal.
- c) The Bank does not tolerate attending work under the influence of alcohol. Employees found to have contravened this shall be dismissed.

25.0 EQUAL EMPLOYMENT OPPORTUNITY

25.1 POLICY

- a) This policy applies to all staff including contractors and covers all work-related functions and activities including external training courses sponsored by the Bank.
- b) It also applies for all recruitment, selection and promotion decisions.
- c) The objective of the Bank's Equal Opportunity Policy is to improve business success by:
 - I. attracting and retaining the best possible employees
 - II. providing a safe, respectful and flexible work environment
 - III. delivering our services in a safe, respectful and reasonably flexible way

25.2 DISCRIMINATION, SEXUAL HARASSMENT AND BULLYING

- a) The Bank is committed to providing a workplace free from discrimination, sexual harassment and bullying. Behaviour that constitutes discrimination, sexual harassment or bullying will not be tolerated and will lead to action being taken, which may include dismissal.
- b) For the purposes of this policy, the following definitions apply:

1. Discrimination:

- i Direct discrimination occurs when someone is treated unfairly and is disadvantaged because of a personal characteristic.
 - ii Indirect Discrimination occurs where treating everybody the same way, disadvantages someone because of a personal characteristic.
- 2. Sexual harassment includes unwelcome conduct of a sexual nature in circumstances in which a reasonable person, having regard to all the circumstances, would have anticipated that the person harassed would be offended, humiliated or intimidated.
 - 3. Workplace bullying may include an environment that is directed toward an employee, or group of employees, that creates a risk to health and safety e.g., physical and/or verbal abuse, excluding or isolating individuals; or giving impossible tasks.
 - 4. The Bank provides equal opportunity in employment to all suitably able people without discrimination based on a personal characteristic. They include:
 - a. Age
 - b. Breastfeeding
 - c. Career Status
 - d. Disability/Impairment
 - e. Employment Activity
 - f. Gender Identity
 - g. Industrial Activity
 - h. Marital Status

- i. Parental Status
 - j. Personal association with someone having any of these characteristics
 - k. Physical Features
 - l. Political Activity/ Belief
 - m. Pregnancy
 - n. Race
 - o. Religious Activity/ Belief
 - p. Sexual Orientation
5. Any employee found to have contravened this policy will be subjected to disciplinary action.
6. Employees must report any behaviour that constitutes sexual harassment, bullying or discrimination to their BM/HOD.
7. Employees will not be victimized or treated unfairly for raising an issue or making a complaint.

25.3 PROCEDURE: TO MAKE A COMPLAINT

1. If you believe you are being, or have been, discriminated against, sexually harassed or bullied, you should follow this procedure:
 - a. Tell the offender the behaviour is offensive, unwelcome, and against the Bank's policy and should stop (only if you feel comfortable enough to approach them directly, otherwise speak to your supervisor). Keep a written record of the incident(s).
 - b. If the unwelcome behaviour continues, contact your supervisor or branch manager for support or the Human Resource Department. If the one harassing you is your Supervisor or Branch Manager, then a report should be made to the Human Resource Department directly
2. Employees should feel confident that any complaint made would be treated as confidential as far as possible.

25.4 PROCEDURE: TO RECEIVE A COMPLAINT

1. When a branch manager receives a complaint or becomes aware of an incident that may contravene the Bank's Equal Employment Opportunity Policy, the following procedure should be followed:
 - a. Listen to the complaint seriously and treat the complaint confidentially. Allow the complainant to bring another person to the interview if they choose to.
 - b. Ask the complainant for the full story, including what happened, step by step.
 - c. Take notes, using the complainant's own words.
 - d. Ask the complainant to check your notes to ensure your record of the conversation is accurate.
 - e. Explain and agree on the next action with the complainant.

- f. If investigation is not requested (and the branch manager is satisfied that the conduct complained is not in breach of the Bank's Equal Employment Opportunity Policy) then the manager should:
 - i Act promptly
 - ii Maintain confidentiality
 - iii. Pass copy of notes on to the human resource department

2. If an investigation is requested or is appropriate, the following procedure must be adopted:

25.5 PROCEDURE: TO INVESTIGATE A COMPLAINT

- a. Do not assume guilt.
- b. Advise on the potential outcomes of the investigation if the allegations are substantiated.
- c. Interview all directly concerned, separately.
- d. Interview witnesses, separately.
- e. Keep records of interviews and the investigation.
- f. Interview the alleged harasser, separately and confidentially and let the alleged harasser know exactly what offence they are being accused of. Give them a chance to respond to the accusation. Make it clear they do not have to answer any questions; however, the Manager will still decide regardless.
- g. Listen carefully and record details.
- h. Ensure confidentiality, minimize disclosure.
- i. Decide on appropriate action based on investigation and evidence collected.
- j. Check to ensure the action meets the needs of the complainant and the Bank.

Possible outcomes

If after investigation management finds the complaint is justified, management will discuss with the complainant the appropriate outcomes which may include:

- i Disciplinary action to be taken against the perpetrator (counselling, warning or dismissal)
- ii Staff training
- iii. Additional training for the perpetrator or all staff, as appropriate
- iv. Counseling for the complainant
- v. An apology (the particulars of such an apology to be agreed between all involved)

26.0 CONFLICT OF INTEREST POLICY

26.1 POLICY

- a) Conflict of interest arises whenever the personal, professional or business interests of an employee are potentially at odds with the best interests of the Bank.

b) All employees are required to act in good faith towards the Bank. Employees need to be aware of the potential for a conflict of interest to arise and should always act in the best interests of the Bank.

c) As individuals, employees may have private interests that are from time-to-time conflict, or appear to conflict, with their employment with the Bank. Employees should aim to avoid being put in a situation where there may be a conflict between

the interest of the Bank and their own personal or professional interests, or those of relatives or friends. Where such a conflict occurs or is perceived to occur, the interest of the Bank will be balanced against the interests of the employees and, unless exceptional circumstances exist, resolved in favour of the Bank.

d) Where it is impossible to define all potential areas of conflict of interest, the employee should raise the matter with their supervisor.

26.2 PROCEDURE

a) Employees must:

- I. Declare any potential, actual or perceived conflicts of interest that exist on becoming employed by the Bank to management.
 - II. Declare any potential, actual or perceived conflicts of interest that arise or are likely to arise during employment by the Bank to Management.
 - III. Avoid being placed in a situation where there is potential, actual or perceived conflict of interest if at all possible.
- b) If an employee declares such an interest, the Bank will review the potential areas of conflict with the employee and mutually agree on practical arrangements to resolve the situation.
- c) Employees must disclose any other employment that might cause a conflict of interest with the Bank to their Manager. Where there are external involvements that do not represent a conflict of interest, these must not affect performance or attendance whilst working at the Bank. If such involvement does affect performance or attendance, it will be considered a conflict of interest.
- d) Employees must not set up or engage in private business or undertake other employment in direct or indirect competition with the Bank using knowledge and/or materials gained during the course of employment with the Bank.

- e) Engaging in other business interests during work hours will result in disciplinary action.
- f) Failure to declare a potential, actual or perceived conflict of interest or to take remedial action agreed with the Bank, in a timely manner, may result in disciplinary action.

27.0 TRAVEL POLICY STATEMENT

- a) The Bank shall put in place policies and regulations which ensure that travel benefits and arrangements are in place to enable employees assigned to work or engaged in other approved official duties or business outside their place of primary assignment, reach their destination safely, in reasonable comfort and in a cost-effective manner.
- b) All aspects of employee travel shall be governed by the highest level of integrity, ethical standards, transparency and accountability that govern all the Bank's operations.
- c) The Bank is committed to minimizing its costs and ecological footprint in terms of travel. As such, all employees are encouraged to take advantage of the use of video/teleconferencing as well as software such as zoom wherever possible in order to minimize the need for travel outside the country.
- d) As a general principle, all travel must be approved and booked well in advance in order to obtain the most cost-efficient and value-for-money fares from available approved travel agencies if the employee is travelling by air.
- e) All employees shall bear in mind at all times and in all places, their key role as Brand Ambassadors for the Bank and ensure that their actions promote and safeguard the credibility of the Bank.
- f) Employees are expected to use approved travel funds in the most efficient and cost-effective manner.
- g) It shall be the responsibility of any employee undertaking a trip to ensure that he/she complies with the policies and regulations related to travel and the responsibility of heads of departments/units and line managers to ensure that

all employees under their supervision comply with all policies and regulations related to travel.

27.1 Employee Development Travel: This includes travels for conferences and meetings where employees would normally make a presentation on their work; training workshops/short

courses and research related travels. Funding for this category of travel may be obtained from the following key sources:

- a. External funding from meeting organizers/funding agencies
- b. Budget Allocation for Conferences approved from the beginning of the year presented by the department

27.2 Project Related Travel: This includes travels related to donor-funded projects and contract/commissioned research. Funding for such travels would normally be agreed upon prior to project commencement and included in the project budget. It would also normally be guided by project/donor specific rules and regulations.

- a) All employees must obtain travel authorization before travelling out of the country, whether for private or business purposes. Application for travel shall consist of completed Travel Request Forms which should reach the final
- b) approving authority at least two clear weeks before the employee is scheduled to travel. The Travel Request Form may be downloaded from the ARB Intranet.
- c) The following categories of employees shall be allowed to travel outside Ghana only with authorization by the Board of Directors
 - a. The Chief Executive Officer
 - b. Heads of Department
 - c. Branch Managers
- d) All other employees shall obtain approval for travel from the Chief Executive Officer through the Human Resource Department.

27.3 Duration of Approved Travel

The duration of stay for any trip approved by the Bank shall be as determined by the itinerary/work plan for the assignment only. There shall be no unauthorised extension of stay on an official assignment to accommodate personal business at the Bank's expense.

28.0 RULES AND REGULATIONS GOVERNING GRIEVANCE

- a) An employee who feels that his/her employment rights or entitlements have been adversely affected due to any of the underlisted perceptions may be considered to be aggrieved:

- I. Violation, misapplication or misinterpretation of the terms of his/her employment contract, terms and conditions of service or the Bank's policies, regulations or procedures.
- II. An allegation that a labor law has been or is being violated.
- III. The Bank shall ensure that all grievances are dealt with as speedily as possible and that no employee or his/her representative shall perceive that they have been victimized in any manner whatsoever, as a direct result of lodging a complaint or initiating grievance procedure.
- IV. No employee shall be discriminated against or otherwise treated unfairly for filing a grievance, testifying or assisting in the investigation process pursuant to a grievance procedure.
- V. All employees shall however take note that any employee who misuses the grievance procedure, and for example, knowingly misrepresents facts in filing a grievance or during investigation of a grievance, shall be subject to disciplinary action under the Bank's rules and procedures related to discipline.

28.1 **PROCEDURE**

- a) The employee should try to resolve the grievance as close to the source as possible. This can be informal and verbal. At this stage, every possible effort should be made
- b) to settle a grievance before the formal grievance process starts. If the matter still cannot be resolved, the process continues and becomes formal.
- c) To start the formal grievance process, the complainant(s) must fully describe their grievance in writing, with dates and locations wherever possible and how they have already tried to settle the grievance.
- d) The person(s) against whom the grievance/complaint is made should be given the full details of the allegation(s) against them. They should have the opportunity and a reasonable time to respond before the process continues.
- e) If the grievance still cannot be resolved, the matter should be referred to the most senior manager for consideration and a final decision. A grievance taken to this level must be in writing from the employee.

28.2 **Guidelines on Grievance Procedure**

- a) Every effort shall be made to investigate and resolve grievance issues referred to as an employee's Head of Department or Branch Manager within five (5) working days. In the event of failure to resolve the issue within the stipulated time, it shall be referred to the Human Resource Department.

- b) If referred to the Human Resource Department, the Human Resource Department in collaboration with the Legal Department, shall make efforts to resolve the matter within two (2) working days. The aggrieved employee shall have further recourse to take the matter up with the Chief Executive Officer

Depending on whether or not a resolution of the issue is achieved and based on the CEO's intervention; the issue may be referred to by the Board of Directors, with advice from the Company Secretary which shall aim at reviewing/hearing and determining the matter within a maximum period of one month. The decision on the matter by the Board shall be final.

29.0 RECRUITMENT, PROMOTION AND SEPARATION

29.1 MANPOWER PLANNING

Manpower planning enables the Bank to project its short to long-term needs so that it can adjust its manpower requirements to meet changing priorities.

29.2 PURPOSE

To ensure a sufficient number of suitably qualified personnel are maintained at all levels throughout the Bank.

29.3 POLICY

- a) Workforce planning and budgeting shall be driven by the number of employees, roles and role profiles of the Bank. The workforce plan defines the number, cost, skill set and timeframe requirements for each position as well as reflecting future areas of growth.
- b) Annual discussions between the HR and functional areas of the **Bank** shall inform the Executive Team on anticipated changes to employee needs for the coming financial year(s). The vision of the **Bank** shall guide these discussions, and consideration will be given to financial capacity.
- c) The CEO and Head of HR or their designate shall sign off on the workforce plan for each year and the associated budget shall be integrated into the respective departmental budgets.
- d) Position deletion and recruitment requests for new and/or replacement positions shall be in accordance with approved departmental workforce plans.
- e) Ad hoc recruitment may be required to overcome unforeseen staff requirements such as, replacements for sudden resignations, death, incapacitation and new projects etc.

- f) Ad hoc recruitment requirements shall be approved as per the established signing authority and communicated to Head of HR as early as possible. Where approved, such ad hoc recruitment will in turn feed into the workforce plan for future planning purposes.
- g) The HR Department shall monitor the implementation of all department workforce plans.
- h) All appointments of officers who are not managerial staff shall be approved by the CEO. All managerial staff shall be approved by the Board of Directors.

30.0 RECRUITMENT

30.1 PURPOSE

To attract, select and retain the best talent and ensure that appointments are made on merit through a fair and equitable selection process.

30.2 POLICY

- a) All standard recruitment activities shall be within the approved workforce plan. Any recruitment for non-budgeted positions will require special approval from the relevant signing authority.
- b) The Bank shall adopt fair and consistent methods of recruitment and selection so as to select the most suitable candidate to meet the requirements of the job.
- c) All vacancies shall be advertised internally. External adverts may be considered after a search for a suitable internal candidate for the role is unsuccessful.
- d) A decision may be made to recruit straight from outside the Bank for strategic or other reasons.
- e) Shortlisting shall be conducted by HR in collaboration with the functional Head.
- f) An appropriate assessment shall be conducted and the best candidate selected.
- g) The Corporate Scoring method shall be used and not individual scoring.
- h) No candidate shall be employed without first being interviewed by a selection of assessors made up of Head, HR and four other key Management staff. A Board member may take part in the assessment of Branch Managers.

- i) All offer letters and employment contracts shall be issued by the HR Department in accordance with approved templates and signed off by the Head of HR or the CEO or the Board Chairman as per the established signing authority.
- j) The HR Department is the facilitator for the recruitment process and shall advise the CEO on selection decision of candidates. No critical role shall be vacant for more than two months.

30.3 PROCEDURE

- a) Create a position description for the job covering key activities, tasks, skills required, expectations, deliverables and safety considerations. When advertising, avoid discriminatory language but rather target the attributes of the potential candidate.
- b) The recruitment process may include all the following:
 - I. Filling of an application form
 - II. Interviews
 - III. Practical testing

30.4 SELECTION POLICY

- a) Selection shall be based on the highest score. However, if the first candidate decides not to accept the offer, then the second highest will be selected except the candidate is completely unsuitable for the position.
- b) **Selection criteria:**

Candidate selection shall be based on the following;

 - i Extent i.e., breadth or range of relevant experience
 - ii Qualification and Training
 - iii Capacity for development
 - iv Relevant personal qualities
 - v probation
 - vi Reference and Academic Qualification Checks
 - vii Medical examination
 - viii Police Report
- c) Existing staff shall be given priority when filling vacant positions. Recruitment from outside shall be made only when staff do not meet the criteria of the position.
- d) Short listing will be confined to applicants who satisfy the stated criteria in section

- e) Qualifications, knowledge, skills and experience required for the position must be listed as essential or desirable. Although qualifications are pre-requisites for many positions, it should be recognized that many skills and abilities are acquired other than through formal education.
- f) Staff may also be appointed on fixed term contracts.
- g) The minimum entry qualification for appointment shall be either of the following;
 - I. SSSCE/ WASSCE / NVTI with credit in five subjects including English and Mathematics or its equivalent.
 - II. Higher National Diploma (HND)
 - III. First degree or its equivalent
- h) The successful candidates shall be given letter of appointment setting out clear terms and conditions according to the Conditions of Service.

This includes:

 - I. The nature of employment
 - II. Salary Point
 - III. Salary Scale
 - IV. Effective Date
 - V. Designation
 - VI. Hours of Work
 - VII. Other Benefit
- i) The candidates shall acknowledge acceptance of the job offer in writing to the Human Resource Department with two recent passport pictures.

30.5 INTERVIEW PROCESS

30.5.1 PURPOSE

To ensure all applicants are provided with equal opportunity to present their cases for appointment and the Selection Panel base their decision on criteria relevant to the position.

30.5.2 INTERVIEW PANEL

CLASSIFICATION	PANEL COMMITTEE
Management	HR / CEO/ CS/ Board of Directors
Staff	HR / HOD or Unit Head and Three other Management members
Branch Managers	HR/ CEO /HoP/ HoL/ Chair of HR/Gov Committee
Key Management	HR/ CEO/ External Consultant / CS /3 Directors
CEO/ Dep. CEO	HR/ External Consultant /3 Director / CS/ Relationship Manager from BOG

Applicants shall be notified at least two weeks before the interview date by the Human Resource Department.

30.5.3 INTERVIEW REPORT

- a) An interview assessment sheet shall be completed by the Panel /Interviewers after the interview.
- b) the interview panel/interviewers shall submit a report to the CEO stating the following;
 - I. The recommended salary and benefit
 - II. Place and the date of joining
 - III. Grade
 - IV. Any assurances given to the candidate with regard to the salary increase / re-designations at the end of the probation period and job profile.
 - V. Details of any special requirements or conditions relating to the appointments.
- c) The successful candidate shall be given a letter of appointment setting out clear terms and conditions according to the Conditions of Service.
- d) This includes:
 - I. The nature of employment
 - II. Grade
 - III. Salary
 - IV. Effective Date of Appointment
 - V. Designation
 - VI. Hours of Work, and
 - VII. Other Benefits
- e) The candidate shall acknowledge acceptance of the job offer in writing to the Human Resource Department with two recent passport pictures.

30.6 INDUCTION

30.6.1 INTRODUCTION

Induction is a systematic and formal procedure for integrating a new Employee into the Bank. It aims at giving all the relevant information to the new employee and make the employee adjust comfortably in the new environment of the Bank. It is a structured orientation programme which offers an excellent opportunity to new recruits to learn comprehensively about the Bank.

30.6.2 PURPOSE

To ensure that a new employee settles down smoothly into the Bank so as to reach a standard level of performance as soon as possible.

30.6.3 POLICY

1. The Bank will make sure all new employees feel welcome and are ready to start work safely and competently.
2. Upon joining the Bank, all employees first and foremost shall sign an Oath of Secrecy, which shall be witnessed by the HR. This is to ensure that the employee will observe the strictest professional secrecy and will not divulge to any parties

whomsoever at any time, information concerning the transactions of the Bank and its customers; unless otherwise instructed to do so by the Board or Management.

3. Every employee shall renew their Oath of Secrecy each time they are appointed to a new role, and this shall be filed on their personnel files. This shall be administered by the Human Resource Department.

30.6.4 BENEFITS

1. It gives maximum relevant information to the new employee in the shortest time.
2. It eliminates the feelings of uneasiness, anxiety, apprehensions etc. in the new employee.
3. It familiarizes the new Employee with the Business Goals, Bank's set up, its Operations and People so as to make him/ her productive at the earliest.
4. It enhances the image of the Bank as a people friendly organisation.
5. It helps in reducing the turnover of the employees.

30.6.5 FOCUS

Efforts have to be made by all concerned to integrate the Induction Process with the “Goals and Objectives” of the Bank so as to make it result oriented and dynamic.

30.6.6 SCOPE

The practice of Induction will be applicable to all new employees in the Bank and on appointment to new positions.

30.6.7 RESPONSIBILITY

Head, HR shall be responsible for administering the process of Induction.

30.6.7 PROCEDURE

- a) An appropriate Induction Schedule shall be prepared by HR just after the selected employee confirms his date of joining.
- b) All newly recruited staff shall as part of their orientation spend three days in each department.
- c) An induction programme for new employees shall contain the following:
 - I. Introductions
 - II. Bank’s History
 - III. Bank’s Vision and Mission
 - IV. Operations and Organizational Structure
 - V. Rules and regulations
 - VI. Policies
 - VII. Workplace tour
 - VIII. Health and safety procedures and evacuation
 - IX. Safe working plan
 - X. Training plan
 - XI. IT system orientation
- d) The prepared Induction Schedule shall be given to all concerned well in advance and a copy of it shall be given to the new employee on the day of his joining the Bank, along with the guidance as to how to go about it.

30.6.9 ROLE OF THE INDUCTEE

- a) The Inductee shall undergo the Induction in accordance with the Induction Schedule given to him.
- b) The Inductee will be required to prepare a brief report on his Induction and submit it to the Human Resource Department on completion of the Induction Process.

30.7 PROBATION

- a) Probation is a period of review and appraisal to make sure both the Bank and the employee are satisfied that the role is being performed as advertised.
- b) The appointment will be confirmed only when the employee satisfactorily completes their probation, and the Bank is satisfied with their performance.

30.7.1 POLICY

- a) All employees appointed shall serve a probationary period of not less than six (6) months and may be confirmed after proven good conduct and diligent job
- b) performance. The probationary period may be extended by the Bank, if in the opinion of the Bank, the employee's service has been unsatisfactory.
- c) During the Probationary Period, the Head of Department or the Branch Manager shall present a report to the Human Resource Department after two months of the appointment to help track the performance of the probationer through the following factors:
 - I. Knowledge, Skills and Deliverables on the job
 - II. Attitude towards work and the Bank
 - III. Behavior with Superiors and Peers
 - IV. Ability to adjust to the requirements of the job
 - V. Adherence to the Bank's organizational values and discipline.
- d) At the end of the probation period the employee may be considered for confirmation based on the Review Report of the Supervisor and the respective Departmental Head.

30.8 RE-HIRING

A former employee may be re-hired provided that he/she has a satisfactory record and a vacancy is available. It is at the discretion of the Management/ Board of the Bank to approve or disapprove such re-engagement.

30.8.1 PROCEDURE

- a) Two weeks before the end of the probation period a Probation Appraisal Form (Appendix 2) will be sent to the department head by the Human Resource Department, seeking a recommendation on the confirmation of the appointment.
- b) There are three possible recommendations:
 - I. Appointment should be confirmed as per the due date in accordance with the Appointment Letter.

- II. The probationary appointment should be extended further for a specified number of months, advising the employee to improve upon their shortcomings / weak areas.
 - III. The appointment should be terminated. This exercise has to be necessarily done before the expiry of the probation period.
- c) The recommendations must be shown to have been discussed with the Employee and duly signed by the Immediate Supervisor prior to being forwarded to the Human Resource Department for action.
- d) In providing Feedback the Supervisor should:
- I. Express his concerns clearly without undue delay and in appropriate circumstances
 - II. Focus on critical areas.
 - III. Acknowledge good work performance.
- e) Providing Performance Feedback to the Probationer and taking his signature on the Probation Appraisal Form by the Supervisor is very important and essential.
- f) Extension of Probation:
- I. The probation period of Staff who are not Management members may be extended in marginal cases at the discretion of Management.
 - II. The probation period of Management members may be extended at the discretion of the Board of Directors.
 - III. The probation period may be extended only at the end of the original probation period.
 - IV. Only one extension can be recommended and this cannot exceed half the duration of the original probationary period.
- g) In reviewing a recommendation for termination of employment, the Human Resource Department should determine the following:
- I. Whether the employee was given adequate resources to perform.
 - II. Whether the probationer had received adequate supervision and instruction to reach the expected standard of performance.
- h) During this review the Human Resource Department may consult with the Departmental Head, the immediate Supervisor or any other person considered appropriate.

30.9 CONFIRMATION

Confirmation of appointment to all employees shall be in writing.

30.9.1 PURPOSE

To build up the confidence and create a sense of stability for the employee in the Bank for a long-term career.

30.9.2 POLICY

- a) An employee appointed may be confirmed only after the successful completion of the probation period.
- b) Confirmation letter should reach the employee before the expiry of the last day of probation.

30.9.2 PROCEDURE

- a) Give at least two bi-monthly formal appraisals before the end of probation.
- b) At the end of the probation period, employee shall attend a confirmation interview and be advised of the result.
- c) The Probation Review Report shall be sent back to the Human Resource Department at least a week before the expiry of probation period.
- d) Along with the confirmation letter a copy of the employee's pay structure (in case there is a revision in the same) and other allowances will be given to the employee.

30.10 ISSUING OF OFFER LETTER / APPOINTMENT LETTER

30.10.1 POLICY

- a) On selection of an eligible candidate, an Appointment Offer letter shall be issued.
- b) Normally, new recruits will be expected to assume duty within a month of receipt of appointment letter.
- c) Appointment letter will be issued at the time of joining within a week after submission of all required documents.
- d) Offer letter will be signed by the Chief Executive Officer for all employees except Management members.
- e) Confirmation letters will be signed by the Head HR once the Probation Review Report (Appendix 2) is signed by the HOD for all employees except Management members.
- f) Any Service /Salary Review letter will be issued by the Human Resource Department.

30.11 PROMOTION

- a) One may be considered for promotion upon the availability of a position where the person has worked continuously for a minimum of three (3) years of meritorious service on a grade. However, it would be by recommendation of Management and approved by the Board of Directors.
- b) One may also be considered for promotion upon the availability of a position within the same grade where the person has worked continuously for a minimum of three (3) years of meritorious service in a grade.
- c) Criteria for promotion shall be as follows:
 - I. Meritorious job performance
 - II. Overall conduct or behavior
 - III. Technical Competencies
- d) Unless the Board declares to the contrary, increment shall be granted annually as per the CBA.
- e) Incremental date for staff shall be first of January each year. However, an officer who assumes duty in the last quarter of the year shall be granted an increment on the first day of January of the year following the ensuing year in consideration to the cost-of-living allowance (C.O.L.A.).
- f) Promotion shall be based on successful appraisal report.
- g) Staff promotion shall be by interview by a panel constituted by Key Management Persons and approved by the CEO.
- h) A staff promoted in a particular year shall not be eligible for promotion for a further 3 years unless the staff has obtained a certificate that is relevant to the job description of the employee or for meritorious reasons in the knowledge of Management.

31.0 PERFORMANCE IMPROVEMENT POLICY

31.1 PROCEDURE

- a) Where an employee's performance or conduct is unsatisfactory, a discussion will be conducted and counselling given to resolve the issue at the initial stage. This should be documented.

- b) If the employee's performance or conduct continues to be unsatisfactory, a capability meeting will be held by a panel of three management members after the initial meeting has failed to yield the needed results.
- c) The employee will be notified in writing specifying the date, time and place of the meeting, details of the areas of performance shortfall as well as the right to be accompanied by a representative.
- d) The level of action at a first capability meeting would normally be a first written warning.
- e) If there is no improvement or there is any deterioration while the first written warning is in force, then, following a second capability meeting a final written warning would be issued.
- f) As part of any decision, the Manager may consider whether there are any alternative jobs available to which the employee might be suited.
- g) Where a final written warning has already been issued but there has not been sufficient improvement in performance to the required level, the decision to terminate employment may be made.
- h) The capability meeting will be reconvened and the employee informed of the decision and the reasons for it.
- i) The decision will be confirmed in writing.
- j) The employee has the right of appeal against the decision within one week of receipt of such notice.

32.0 SEPARATION

32.1 PURPOSE

This policy outlines the regulations, processes and procedures to be followed in various situations when employees are to leave the service of the Bank.

32.2 POLICY

- a) The Bank shall place very high value on its employees who shall be considered a critical resource for achievement of its strategic objectives. The Institution shall therefore recognize that losing employees needlessly comes at the cost of potentially more expensive replacements.

- b) The Bank shall also be mindful that unwanted loss of valued employees will lead to temporary loss of productivity, skills/experience, changes in team dynamics, breaks in established networks and other negative impacts including significant loss of institutional knowledge and lower employee morale. Every effort shall therefore be made to retain key talent.
- c) All employees who leave the Bank no matter the reason or mode of separation, particularly those who have served with distinction, shall be guided to exit with respect and dignity as far as is possible and practicable.
- d) Since exiting employees are able to provide valuable information on their experience in the Bank, the separation process shall include the preparation of “handing over notes” and a component for tapping valuable information in the form of an “exit interview”. Information from exit interviews shall be used to

improve the experiences of existing employees through reviewed policies, procedures and practices with the objective of facilitating employee retention.

- e) Employees who resign, vacate their post, retire, are laid off in a redundancy exercise or for whatever reason leave the Bank, shall be regarded as separated or terminated from employment with the Bank. The separations process shall also address what actions need to be taken in the event of the death of an existing employee.
- f) All the policies on separation contained in this manual shall be read and interpreted in conjunction with the prevailing conditions of service relevant to the various categories of employees.

32.2.1 Types and Nature of Separation for Management and Staff

- a) Separation from the employment of the Bank shall be said to have occurred in the event of any of the situations listed below:
 - I. Resignation
 - II. Vacation of Post
 - III. Retirement (compulsory/voluntary/on health grounds)
 - IV. Redundancy
 - V. Termination
 - VI. Dismissal
 - VII. Death-in-Service
 - VIII. Non-renewal of Contract
 - IX. Non – Confirmation of Appointment

32.2.2 Policies and Regulations on Resignation of Employees

1. An employee may resign his/her appointment by giving notice of his/her intention in writing not later than one month prior to the date on which he/she intends to resign.
2. Outstanding leave may, in certain circumstances, be used as notice period when resigning from the Bank's employment. Employees shall normally serve out the notice required or negotiate specific alternative arrangements.
3. Employees who wish to resign in good standing shall submit a written resignation to the Human Resource Department except where the employee is a Management member. Resignation letters shall clearly state the effective date of resignation. Management members shall submit resignation letters to the Board through the Board Secretary or the CEO.
4. Should an Employee leave his post for more than ten (10) working days without prior notice or any reasonable excuse within the period, it shall be deemed that the employee has vacated his post.
5. In instances where disciplinary or criminal investigations have been or are about to be instituted against an employee, their resignations shall not be accepted.
6. An employee who wishes to resign shall be required to return any property of the Bank in his/her possession, and pay any debts owed before being paid any benefits due. In default, the equivalent value of the item(s) and debts shall be deducted from his/her benefits.

32.3 Procedure for Resignation

Before a Management member shall submit an intention to resign the member shall discuss the intention to resign, reasons for the intended resignation and plausible ways in which all issues pertaining to the resignation can be resolved with the CEO.

In the event the issues raised can be solved but the CEO is unable to resolve the issue, then the CEO shall inform the Board of the intention of the Management to resign.

The Board shall then try to resolve the issue(s). If the Board is unable to resolve the matter, then the Management member can go ahead to serve a notice of intention to resign.

1. A management staff shall serve the notice of his/her intention to resign in writing, through the CEO to the Board through the Board secretary.

2. An employee shall serve the notice of his/her intention to resign in writing, through the HR department.
3. If the resignation is accepted, the Human resource Department shall set a date for an exit interview.

After the exit interview, the Human Resource Department shall issue a letter to the employee accepting the resignation and detailing all entitlements and deductions.

33.0 EXIT POLICY

33.1 POLICY

- The Bank shall ascertain the reasons why the relationship between employee and employer has come to an end. These reasons will be ascertained by way of:
 - Exit Interview. In the process the Bank shall come across some hidden aspects of which should be addressed to establish a better employee- employer relationship.
 - ❖ Exit Interview is a very effective HR tool to elicit reasons for employee turnover and to understand the prevailing organizational climate to take corrective action if required.
 - ❖ It often throws up some very sensitive and vital information about the Bank which normally an employee would not share during his/ her association with the Bank. It also opens windows to the hidden causes of employee turnover.
 - ❖ This practice shall be applicable to all outgoing employees at all levels.

33.2 PROCEDURE

1. The outgoing employee shall be interviewed by the Head, H.R and two other key management persons, two weeks after the notice of intention to resign has been served on the Bank.

After the exit interview, a report shall be generated by the Human Resource Department and then forwarded to the Management committee for deliberation.

2. The information coming out of the Exit Interview will be analyzed by HR at regular intervals to identify the patterns. A summary of the analysis will be presented before Management and an

appropriate action plan shall be drawn to further improve the organizational climate and minimize the employee turnover.

33.3 RETIREMENT

The compulsory retiring age for all senior members of the Bank shall be 60 years.

Any extension of service beyond this age shall be subject to evidence-based need continued services, confirmed medical fitness and any other criteria determined by the Bank.

An employee may retire voluntarily from the service of the Bank at the age of fifty (50). He/ She shall give six (6) months' notice of his/her intention prior to the date of voluntary retirement.

An employee who retires shall be required to return any property of the Bank in his/her possession to his/her Head of department or the Human Resource department before he/she exits. In default, the equivalent value of the item(s) shall be deducted from his/her terminal benefits if any.

33.4 REDUNDANCY POLICY

33.4.1 POLICY

1. It is a general policy objective of the Bank to maintain, where possible, secure employment for its employees by forward planning. The Bank intends to reduce any redundancies which may occur to a minimum, but changes in the pattern or volume of business, in the Bank itself, or in the method of working may sometimes render redundancies unavoidable.
2. Circumstances may arise where changes in the Banking industry, in technology and the organizational requirements of the Bank may lead to the need for redundancies. To minimize the impact of redundancies, the following procedure will be adopted wherever possible. The procedure may need to be adapted in cases of emergency.
3. The Bank's duties in a redundancy procedure differ depending on the number of staff that might be made redundant. Where the Bank may make less than 20 staff redundant then there will be a duty to carry out meaningful consultation and to follow the statutory redundancy procedure.

33.4.2 PROCEDURE

1. Where the possibility of redundancies arises, management will enter consultations with the appropriate employees and employee representatives with a view to consider all of the options. If redundancies are decided upon, consideration will be given to the following criteria, subject to the Bank's business needs at the time:
 - a. Reducing overtime working in affected departments to a level essentially economical to meet contractual commitments or provide essential services.
 - b. Reviewing and restricting recruitment in the staff categories affected and, in those areas, where possible staff surplus might be absorbed.
 - c. Reviewing all contracted or sub-contracted work in areas affected where this action would help reduce the number of redundancies.
 - d. Reviewing the employment of temporary and fixed term contract staff.
 - e. Considering the introduction of short time working where this is practicable.
 - f. Making every effort to offer potentially redundant staff suitable alternative work within the Bank.
2. Where, after due consideration of these alternatives, the Bank considers that the need for redundancies remains, management will give to employees and employee representatives written details of the proposals.
3. As far as possible in advance of the proposed termination date(s), Management will notify all employees that compulsory redundancies are proposed and that a provisional selection has been made. Management will then consult on an individual basis with those employees provisionally selected for redundancy. During this consultation, employees will be informed of the basis of their proposed selection for redundancy and will be invited to make representation on their proposed dismissals.
4. Management shall take due note of and consider any representations before a confirmed selection for redundancy is made.
5. Management shall make every effort to seek alternative employment within the Bank. All redundant employees will be interviewed individually to inform them of any available vacancies, to establish individual requirements, and to consider their suitability for particular jobs. Employees will also be informed of any entitlement to severance pay.

6. Where selection for redundancy is confirmed, employees selected for redundancy will be given the option to resign. Depending on the needs of the Bank, consideration will be given to employees who wish to leave early with a package.
7. If alternative vacancies are offered to redundant employees the terms and conditions which will apply will either be in accordance with the standard terms for the job in question or will be in accordance with those which applied to the employee in the redundant job. Redundant employees accepting an alternative job will be entitled to a trial period.
8. Employees under notice of redundancy will be given permission to take time off work to look for work or training.
9. The Bank will also grant individual counselling to redundant employees.
10. All employees who receive redundancy payments will be given written notification of the way in which their redundancy pay has been calculated.

33.5 TERMINATION

33.5.1 PURPOSE

To outline the provisions relating to an employee's involuntary termination of services.

33.5.2 POLICY

- a. The services of an employee may be terminated for any reason where issue of compliance is concerned and mutuality of interest has ceased to exist.
- b. The employment contract will be terminated by giving one (1) months' notice or pay in lieu of such notice as specified in the appointment letter.
- c. All communications related to the termination shall be in writing.
- d. In case of termination the employee may be given the option to resign at his own request.
- e. The salary for this purpose shall mean the basic salary.
- f. Issues or actions which may result in termination of appointment include loss of confidence, misrepresentation of facts, false claims, wrong information, gross insubordination, moral turpitude, severe misconduct, financial irregularity, abysmal performance issue and criminal offence.

- g. Offences whose sanctions require termination or dismissal shall be referred to the Board. All other offences shall be handled by Management.
- h. There must be sufficient documentary proof relating to aforesaid reason(s) based on which the Termination Letter will be issued by the Human Resource Department and signed by the Chief Executive Officer.

34.0 POLICIES AND REGULATIONS ON DISMISSAL

An employee shall be dismissed for one or more of the reasons enumerated below:

He/she fails to disclose any previous conviction for criminal offence or falsifies testimonials or personal records.

He/she corruptly accepts or attempts to obtain from any persons any gift or consideration as an inducement or reward for doing or fore bearing to do any act in relation to the Bank's affairs or business for himself/herself or for any other person.

He/she shows favour or disfavor in relation to the Bank's affairs or business based on the acceptance of any gift or consideration as an inducement or reward from other persons.

An employee shall be dismissed based upon serious proven misconduct. The employee shall not be granted notice or salary in lieu of notice and the dismissal shall take effect from the date on which he/she is officially notified.

The list above is not exhaustive.

34.1 INTERDICTION

If an employee is charged with an offence punishable by dismissal, the Bank may interdict the employee from duty while investigations are carried out. During the period of interdiction from duty, the employee shall be paid at the rate of one-half (1/2) of his basic salary, but if the employee is exonerated, he/she shall be paid his outstanding salary for the period during which he/she was interdicted. Interdiction of an employee shall be three months. However, the interdiction period may be extended for two (2) additional months if investigations have not been concluded.

35.0 DISCIPLINE AND DISCIPLINARY ACTION POLICY

35.1 POLICY

1. It is the responsibility of each Departmental Head / Branch Head to maintain highest standard of working discipline in the workplace.

2. Matters of discipline, integrity, neglect of duty, insubordination, working in a manner detrimental to the Bank's interest, absenteeism etc. shall be treated as major misconduct.
3. Depending on the gravity and nature of misconduct the following procedure will be adopted by the Human Resource Department.

35.2 PROCEDURE FOR DISCIPLINARY HEARING

35.3 GENERAL DISCIPLINE PROCEDURES

Heads of department must take responsibility for offering appropriate support and advice to their subordinates to ensure correct conduct and adequate/effective implementation of disciplinary procedure.

On recognizing unacceptable conduct (an offence) by a member of their team, Heads Departments or Branch Managers shall follow the steps for disciplinary procedure provided under Section 35.2 below. The procedures must be followed carefully and consistently to result in consistently satisfactory conduct.

Such satisfactory conduct shall be facilitated by Heads of departments and/or Supervisors, ensuring that employees experience consistent consequence management

action which makes them fully aware that where improvement does not result from warnings and cautions, application of disciplinary procedure may ultimately lead to termination of employment.

Breaches of discipline through misconduct could lead to action resulting in dismissal, after due process under the Bank's disciplinary procedure.

35.4 DISCIPLINARY HEARING PROCEDURE

35.4.1 Inter Departmental Procedure

Where an officer of a department or branch commits a minor offence the HOD would proffer the punishment commensurate with the offence as stated in this policy. However, if it is a major offence then the officer would be taken through the DC hearing.

(b) where an officer of a branch commits a minor offence, the Branch Manager would proffer punishment in consultation with the Head of Banking Operations.

Where a Management member is found to have breached any of the offences in the policy, the Management member shall be subject to Disciplinary hearing by the Board of Directors.

A query will be issued by the immediate supervisor or Head and copied to the HR Department, Internal control and Legal Department. If it bothers on compliance issues, then the compliance department shall be copied. If the employee fails to answer the query within stipulated time it shall amount to insubordination to authority or to a more senior officer.

Response to the query would be sent to the person issuing the query and copies to Departments that were copied in the query.

Where the response to the query is not accepted by the Head of department or branch manager, an investigation would be done by the internal Audit Department to ascertain the gravity or truthfulness of the issue. In cases of fraud the police may be involved. While under investigation the employee shall cooperate fully with the investigators. Failure to cooperate may lead to the employee being sanctioned.

The summary report and all documents gathered in the investigation will be passed to the HR Department, who will then forward to the CEO.

If based on the report, the HR department in consultation with the CEO and Head, Legal considers that there are reasonable grounds for disciplinary hearing, then a disciplinary hearing will be arranged.

If the decision reached is that no further action should be taken, then, the HR department would recommend to the Chief Executive Officer that the matter should be closed. If approved the employee will be notified.

The committee set up for the disciplinary hearing shall be Head of BOP, Head, Legal and Head, Credit. In the event the Head legal is not available, the Head, Compliance shall sit in. In the event the Head of Credit is not available, Head, IT shall sit in. In the event the Head of Operation is not available, Head, Finance shall sit in. The Chief Executive Officer will not be part of the Disciplinary Committee.

The Committee after completion of its work will forward its recommendations to the Chief Executive Officer.

The employee shall be allowed to have any representation of their choice. The witness can either be another employee or other person of choice. There should be a representative from the Local Union present at the hearing to ensure fairness and equity. The witness of the employee who is subject to the disciplinary hearing shall not speak during the hearing; unless addressed by the Disciplinary Committee to provide clarifications to the incident or is an expert in the subject matter.

If the employee is found to have committed an act contrary to ARB rules and procedures, then the appropriate sanction shall be applied. If no case is proved against the employee, he/she shall be paid the part of the salary withheld during the period of suspension.

The findings and recommendations will be forwarded to the CEO and the CEO shall have the right to mitigate it downwards for onward approval of the Committee.

Employees have the right of appeal against any formal action under disciplinary procedure. The appeal shall be lodged within 10 working days after receipt of the decision in writing.

Any issue that the policy may not cover shall be sent to the Board for a decision to be made.

35.5 PUNISHMENT FOR OFFENCES

NO	MAJOR OFFENSE	1ST INSTANCE	2ND INSTANCE	3RD INSTANCE	4TH INSTANCE
1.	Any dishonesty or attempted dishonesty. Any act of -Including conspiracy, theft, suppression, bribery, fraud, collusion and forgery or giving false or misleading statements to the bank.	Dismissal			
2.	Gross negligence in carrying out duties including negligence of duty that leads to loss of funds.	Written warning+ Refund	Final warning + Refund	Dismissal	
3.	Intentionally causing damage to the bank's customers or employees' property.	Termination + Refund	Dismissal.		
4.	Gross insubordination	Written warning	2 weeks Suspension	Termination	
5.	Assault (physical or verbal) or any Attempt to assault a person or fighting while on duty or within the Banks premises.	Final warning	Dismissal		
6.	Engaging in business competition with the bank.	Dismissal			
7.	Absence from work for more than ten (10) consecutive working days without valid reason or failing to report absence to	Dismissal			

	bank at earliest possible opportunity				
8.	Persistent lateness or absence from work without valid reason	Written warning	Final warning	Termination	
9.	Forging or altering a medical certificate	Dismissal			
10.	Poor quality of work or persistent failure to meet performance standards/targets	Written warning	Final Written warning	Termination	
11.	Being in possession of firearm or dangerous weapon during working hours.	Final written warning	Termination		
12.	Gambling with other staff during working hours on the bank's premises; this includes all forms of lottery.	Final warning	Termination	Dismissal	
13.	Money laundering	Dismissal			
14.	Abusive or insulting language or signs of rudeness to customers, supervisor or employees.	Final written warning Dismissal	Termination	Dismissal	
15.	Harassment, including sexual harassment.	Dismissal.			
16.	Willful or negligent introduction of a virus into the Bank's or an employees' or other computer systems	Dismissal.			
17.	Divulging of allocated username and/or password to another employee, or any classified information to any third party without authorization	Final warning	Dismissal		
18.	Allowing any third party/co-employee to operate any terminal using	Final warning	Dismissal		

	the allocated username and/ or password.				
19.	Unauthorized use of password/ compromising passwords.	Instance: Dismissal			
20.	Lateness to work five (5) or more times in a month without permission	First Instance: Written Query Hearing	2 nd Instance: Warning Letter	3 rd Instance: Disciplinary	
21.	Insider Trading and/or a break of the personal account dealing procedure	Dismissal			
22.	Exceeding discretionary lending limits without authorization including unauthorized overdrafts and paying against uncleared effects.	Dismissal			
23.	Any breach of confidentiality with regards to the Bank's operations and information	Dismissal			
24.	Creating a conflict of interest within the Bank or acting contrary to the Bank's interest by not observing one's duty of good faith to the Bank	Final written warning	Dismissal		
25.	Failure to follow laid-down procedure/ policies leading to loss of funds.	Written warning +Refund	Final warning+ Refund	Dismissal	
26.	Unauthorized use of Bank's property/facilities	Written warning	Suspension	Termination	
27.	Receiving or soliciting gifts from a customer for work done or service rendered	Written warning	Suspension	Termination	
28.	Stealing	Dismissal and prosecution			

29.	Suppression of customer credit	Dismissal			
30.	Collusion with customers to dupe the Bank	Dismissal and prosecution			
31.	Cross firing	Final warning			
32.	Breaking of oath of secrecy: Divulging information, which is not in the public domain obtained in the course of performing duties in the bank, about the bank and person with whom the bank may have dealings without the requisite authority or consent.	Dismissal			
33.	Unauthorized facilities	Suspension			
34.	Unauthorized overdraft	Suspension without pay for one month	Summary Dismissal However, the Board may decide otherwise.		
35.	Absenteeism	Verbal warning	Written warning	Subsequent Written warning plus any of the following should apply: Suspension without pay Withholding annual increment Termination of appointment	
36.	Insubordination or refusal to obey legitimate and reasonable instructions.	Suspension without pay	Summary dismissal or termination of appointment.		

37.	Refusal to proceed on annual leave.	Suspension without pay Summary.	dismissal or termination of appointment		
38.	Usage of office property or facility for another purpose not official.	One month Suspension without pay	Summary dismissal	Termination of appointment	
39.	Engaging in any activities outside official duties likely to bring the bank's name into disrepute.	Written Warning without pay	Suspension	Termination of appointment	
40.	Making personal representation to members of the Board of Directors.	Written Warning	Suspension without pay	Termination of appointment	
41	a. Failure to complete work assignment on timely basis b. Producing substandard services. c. Failure to meet targets/submission of reports d. Failure to adhere to Departmental or Branch operational Manual	Verbal warning	Written warning	Subsequent Written warning plus any of the following shall apply: Suspension without pay Withholding annual increment Forfeiture of annual bonus Reduction in grade	
42.	Poor Supervision leading to loss of Funds	Refund or Termination depending on the gravity of the loss of funds			
43.	Unauthorized transfer of funds from internal account	Termination/ Dismissal			
44.	OPERATIONAL OFFENCES		Final warning	Suspension	

a. Failure to adhere to personal, corporate and counter cheque administration procedures. b. Non booking or improper booking recording) of fixed deposit in the register c. Non adherence to KYC issues. d. Failure to check or authenticate attendance register by a manager/supervisor e. Failure to identify ceased/stopped salary from (employer) by a manager especially when the customer is indebted to the Bank. f. Verbal abuse of the superior officer. g. Persistent lateness to work (8:30am) without permission (3 days within a month) h. Unauthorized expenditure by a branch i. Manager/exceeding expenditure limit without approval. j. Suppression of customer deposit. A. Failure to adhere to pre-disbursement conditions.	Written warning				
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	B. Varying of loan terms without approval a. Failure to declare cash shortage/overs. k. Granting of unauthorized facility. l. Non clearance of long outstanding items on reconciliation statement with 14 days m. Absence of dual control over treasury (keys and books). n. Long outstanding items in office accounts (sundry debtors & creditors) with 14 days. o. Specie movement without due process/procedure. p. Failure to attend training without permission. q. Lateness to training after 30 minutes when it starts without permission r. Failure to open at 8:30am for banking business. s. Use of phone/tablet while serving customers. t. Non response to query letter at a given time. u. Breach of oath of secrecy.				
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	v. Failure to update itinerary book (CSWE) w. Keying a transaction without voucher.				
	MINOR OFFENCE				
45.	Leaving bank premises while on duty without authorization on two consecutive times	Verbal warning	Written warning	Termination	
46.	Under the influence of alcohol or in possession of alcohol on duty	Final written warning	Dismissal		
47.	Under the influence of or in possession of illicit drugs or such other substances	Dismissal			
48.	Failure to carry out bank health, safety and security regulations	Written warning	Final written warning	Dismissal	
49.	Driving a bank vehicle without authority	Written warning + Refund	Final written warning	Dismissal	
50.	Failure or refusal to carry out reasonable instructions of supervisor/ manager	Written warning	Final written warning	Termination	
51.	Excessive Tardiness/Sluggishness	Final written warning	Termination		
52.	Spending unauthorized and/or excessive time on the internet, e-mail or other communications systems	Written warning	Final written warning	Termination	
53.	Viewing, downloading, copying, storing and/ or distributing undesirable, indecent, obscene graphics, sounds text from the internet, e-mail or any data storing utility on the banks computer system.	Final written warning	Termination		

54.	Over drawing your accounts and not rectifying them by close of business, the next working day by staff	Written warning	Final written warning	Termination	
55.	Inability to meet debt repayment obligation leading to reputational risk to the bank	Final warning	Dismissal		
56.	Unauthorized use of Bank's property/facilities	Written warning	Suspension	Termination	
57.	Engaging in additional/part time jobs during working hours.	Termination			
58.	Undertaking official duties while on leave without leave recall	Written warning	Suspension	Summary Dismissal	
59.	Leaving the office without permission	Verbal warning only	Written warning only	Written warning +any of the following should apply: Suspension without pay, for each week of offence, one month suspension, withholding annual increment	Termination of appointment
60.	Receiving gifts or remuneration of any description for work done for a customer	Dismissal or Termination of appointment depending on gravity			
61.	Borrowing from or lending to other staff.	Written warning	Suspension	Termination	

NOTES:

In case of gross misconduct/fraud a Disciplinary Committee shall be constituted to identify an appropriate sanction and recommend it to the Chief Executive Officer and the Board for approval.

Dismissal does not vindicate one from any further action that will be taken by the Bank.

In all cases management or the Board shall determine the appropriate punishment.

36.0 PERSONAL DEVELOPMENT OF EMPLOYEES

36.1 AIM

To provide a framework for training and development that ensures staff have necessary competencies to deliver on strategic and operational plans of the Bank.

36.2 POLICY

1. The Bank shall give employees adequate training to enable them do their job effectively and efficiently. The Bank believes training is a two-way process. The Bank encourages employees to participate and to highlight any gaps in their own skills or knowledge that they believe they have.
2. Management shall provide a programme for training of all staffs based on skills and knowledge gaps identified through training needs assessment and during the performance appraisal; and made available to the Board through the Chief Executive Officer by 15th January every year.
3. All new employees shall go through a scheduled training programme for a period of not less than four (4) weeks.
4. Training includes internal on-the-job training, written instructions such as standard operating procedures, coaching, external training and courses.
5. Staff shall benefit from on-the-job training especially through job rotation.
6. Staff may also benefit from training programs organized by recognized Institutions including: Association of Rural Banks, ARB Apex Bank Ltd, GIMPA, UGBS, National Banking College and other Consultants etc.
7. Staff may also be attached to other Banks or Financial Institutions for training as and when Management finds this necessary to enable the staff work effectively.

8. Directors with the relevant professional background and other experiences shall be encouraged to run training programmes for staff. There shall also be informal interactions by Directors with staff once a year to encourage frankness, innovation and open dialogue and enhance problem solving skills of staffs.

36.3 PROCEDURE

36.3.1 Identification of Training Need

- a. To identify training needs of staff, Heads of Departments and Branch Managers shall identify and submit training needs of their staff to the H.R Department at the end of every year.

The need identification shall be done through

- i Annual Performance Appraisal (Individual Needs)
 - ii Directives from Directors/ Functional Heads/ Direct Supervisors
- b. In the middle of every year, a training needs assessment shall be conducted by Human Resource Department to ascertain whether the training needs stated by the staff at the end of the previous year is still relevant.
 - c. Training programme and budget will be drawn and a copy given to the Board for approval.
 - d. All staff who undergo training shall fill out a training assessment form to enable the Bank computer the relevance of the training attended and if the goals for the intended training was achieved.

36.3.2 Classification of Training Needs

Individual Training Needs evolved from Performance Appraisal shall be classified into three (3) Categories:

- i **Technical Training:** All Job /Work related training needs shall come under technical training.
- ii **Behavioral Training:** All training needs related to employee's behaviour & attitude shall come under Behavioral Training.
- iii **Business Needs Training:** All Organizational Training Requirements mainly based on the new trends shall come under Business Needs Training.

36.3.3 Compilation & Prioritization of Training Needs

Training needs shall be compiled and prioritized. Prioritization of needs shall be done taking into consideration two principles:

- i Organizational Needs (Critical Areas)
- ii Majority of areas are commonly identified by a greater number of the employees.

36.3.4 Preparation of Training Calendar

Training Calendar shall be prepared by properly scheduling the programmes as per prioritization and it shall be circulated to all Functional Heads.

36.3.5 Evaluation of Training

All employees who undergo training will be evaluated before and after their training to check the employees and the training modules' effectiveness. This detail will be recorded in their respective personnel files.

The employees are evaluated to ascertain their productivity and their skill potential so that they can be graded based on their performance. If after the training period the employee has not yet met the minimum requirement, another training course will be recommended, however, if the employee's performance is not yet satisfactory a decision would be taken.

It is the responsibility of the concerned Department to ensure that employees undergo the specified training. Once it is decided to nominate an employee for a training programme; it will be the responsibility of the HOD/BM to relieve him for such programme.

During the calendar year it is envisaged that each employee undergoes at least 8 hours of Training.

Training programmes can be organized in -house and for specialized training, employees can be sent to external courses.

37.0 PROFESSIONAL DEVELOPMENT

37.1 PURPOSE

- a. In order to encourage employees to make efforts for their self-development, the Bank is committed to support all initiatives for the growth and development of all employees.

37.2 POLICY

1. The Bank is a learning organisation and encourages staff self-development. Registration and Examination fees relating to passing all papers in each level of local professional courses relevant to enhancing the Bank's Business shall be fully reimbursed upon submission of relevant receipts and results slip. Such qualifications include: **ICA, CIMA, ACCA, ACIB, CIB Gh, CIM, PMP, ICT PROFESSIONAL COURSES, etc.**
2. The Bank shall award staff who pass all the relevant professional examinations and admitted into membership an incremental jump on the relevant grade.
3. Any staff embarking on any professional programme shall seek approval from Management before embarking on such a programme.
4. A cash award and subscription shall be paid upon completion of the programme.
5. The Bank shall pay for only one professional course obtained by a staff within the period of service.
6. A member of staff shall qualify to embark on a relevant professional course three (3) years after being engaged by the Bank.

37.3 PROCEDURE

1. Any employee (excluding management members) who wishes to use this facility should apply in writing along with the details of the course content for permission to their Head of Department.
2. This Application will then be forwarded to the HR Department for further processing and for onward approval from the C.E.O.

The concerned HOD and Human Resource Department shall certify that the course proposed to be undertaken by the employee is compatible with the Candidate's Job profile & Growth Potential in the Organisation and that it will equip him with enhanced skills and knowledge.

If a management member intends to do a professional course which is relevant to their area of expertise, the Chief Executive Officer shall forward the request to the Board of Directors for approval.

The candidate is required to inform the Human Resource Department at least a week in advance before proceeding on the study leave. Confirmed employees who wish to pursue professional courses may be considered.

38.0 TRANSFER

38.1 POLICY

1. The Bank may transfer any employee from one place to the other or from one function to another in the interest of the business.
2. The Bank reserves the right to transfer any member of staff as and when it is deemed necessary or when the employee (excluding management) has been in the role for more than 4 years without being transferred.

38.2 ENTITLEMENTS ON TRANSFER

An employee will be entitled to the following one location to another:

- a. A transfer allowance of one month's salary shall be paid to the affected employee outside the Akuapem Ridge while staff who are transferred on the Ridge will be paid half their basic salary.
- b. Where the transfer is intended to extend beyond three months or remain indefinite, the Bank shall pay the fare of the employee and his/ her family to the point of transfer as per the State Transport Corporation Approved fare rates.

39.0 13TH MONTH SALARY

Staff may be entitled to a 13th month salary on condition that the performance of the Bank can support it and payment of same shall be at the discretion of the Board. For staff who have spent less than one (1) year with the Bank, their 13th month salary would be prorated.

40.0 NOTCH INCREMENTS

Staff who exceed the ceiling of a notch on a particular grade shall be moved to the first notch of the next grade based on performance or be paid a lump sum in lieu of moving to the next grade.

40.1 PERFORMANCE MANAGEMENT POLICY

40.1.1 POLICY

1. The Performance management policy applies to all employees of the Bank. It recognizes the mutual obligations of management and employees to be responsible for their performance.

2. Performance management is a two-way process between managers and employees, negotiated between both parties and focused on the achievement of agreed goals. Managers will ensure that performance management processes are in place and operating effectively.
3. Employees will be involved in performance management processes that enable them to be effective and efficient in their work. They will have access to appropriate information and opportunities for knowledge and skill development. This will provide support to meet outcomes that have been negotiated and agreed within the context of goals of the work unit and based on the strategy for the year. Agreed outcomes will be recognized through the provision of balanced, objective feedback about performance.
4. Management will make work expectations clear to all staff and establish procedures that actively and effectively enable the development of each employee's performance.
5. Active and constructive participation in performance management will be encouraged by the Bank by recognizing and valuing all contributions, ensuring fair and consistent treatment of employees and seeking feedback on performance management processes.

6. Key elements make up the Performance Management Framework

- a. An explicit and up to date role duty statement or job and person specification which reflects the skills and competences required of the person and establishes the outcomes required of the position.
- b. Effective induction processes which explain and confirm expectations, particularly where work locations and /or roles have changed.
- c. Performance planning which establishes the link between organizational or work unit goals and agreed indicators of individual performance.
- d. Personal development plan which provides an outline of action to be taken to develop employee skills and knowledge to meet objectives.
- e. Recognition which explicitly acknowledges achievement.
- f. Feedback and review which enables employees and managers to identify areas for improvement and learning and development opportunities. Verbal and written feedback will be given at least once annually.
- g. Grievance procedures which enable employees to resolve any matters of concern.

- h. Addressing underperformance which ensures that ongoing issues are identified and resolved.
- 7. Structured planning, feedback and review will be conducted at least quarterly and will be supported by more frequent performance feedback, dependent upon the nature and duration of tenure of the appointment.
- 8. Performance management is a confidential process, with access to any documentation resulting from the performance management process normally only available to the employee and supervisor. Other Departmental personnel may have access for legitimate purposes with the knowledge of the employee.
- 9. These Principles underpin this policy:
 - a. honesty, openness and transparent processes
 - b. focus on continuous improvement
 - c. equity and fairness
 - d. mutual obligation
 - e. explicitly agreed expectations
 - f. empowering and supportive culture

40.2 OUTCOMES

- 1. The successful implementation of the policy will achieve the following outcomes:
 - a. Shared understanding of the organization's direction.
 - b. Performance management processes which focus on the achievement of individual and department goals, and which are established and maintained in all Branches.
 - c. Improved service delivery, training and learning outcomes for employees.
 - d. Recognition of employee contributions.
 - e. Improved employee well-being.
 - f. A culture of continuous improvement and feedback is evident in all Departments of the Bank.

40.3 RESPONSIBILITIES & ACCOUNTABILITIES

- 1. Improving organizational and work unit performance is a joint responsibility of employees and management.
 - a. It is expected that all employees will take responsibility for improving their performance and perform their duties in a competent and efficient manner in line with organizational and legislative requirements.

- b. Employees have a responsibility to:
 - i Be actively involved in the performance management processes of their department.
 - ii Continuously improve their performance and be accountable within the responsibility and authority of the position.
 - iii Establish a documented process, in negotiation with their immediate supervisor that reflects personal goals and organizational priorities and a shared commitment to achieving these.
 - iv Negotiate an objective approach to monitoring performance against agreed outcomes, including the collection and analysis of relevant data and information.
 - v Be actively involved in the resolution of grievances that may result from the performance management process.

BM's/HOD's have additional responsibilities to:

- i Ensure employees have clear, up to date and explicit role or duty statements, or job and person specifications.
- ii Ensure effective performance management processes and plans are established in their department.
- iii Incorporate a participative approach with employees in working through performance management processes and issues.
- iv Ensure employees who are new to a role or Department participate in an induction program.
- v Ensure that structured and regular feedback is provided for all employees regarding the achievement of performance against agreed outcomes.
- vi Appropriately delegate the responsibility for performance management where necessary to ensure that all staff receive regular feedback and performance recognition.
- vii Ensure performance management processes conducted with each employee are documented.
- viii Actively address performance concerns as they arise.
- ix Support training where personal or professional developmental needs are identified.
- x Provide fair and accurate performance assessments based on identified data collection processes.
- xi Provide clear guidelines and criteria for promotion and reclassification processes.

- xii Promote and develop a healthy work place culture that has regard for employees' psychological well-being.
- xiii Model and encourage performance management practices consistent with the principles established in this policy, including seeking feedback on performance.
- xiv Ensure that they have the skills necessary to implement the policy effectively.
- xv Conduct performance management practices in accordance with all relevant regulations, policies and guidelines.
- xvi Report on the outcomes of the performance management process to the Human Resource Department through the annual reporting cycle.

40.4 PERIOD OF THE PERFORMANCE APPRAISAL

- 1. Performance Review Period will be from January – December.
- 2. Performance Appraisal will be done semiannually.

40.5 PROCESS OF PERFORMANCE APPRAISAL

Sending the Performance Appraisal Forms

- a. Format

The Performance Appraisal forms will be sent to all employees for the first half in July and for the second half in January the following year.

- b. Design / Contents of the Performance Appraisal Form

- I. The Performance Appraisal form consists of the following sections:

- c. Performance Evaluation
- d. Competence Evaluation
- e. Recommendations
- f. Development Plan
- g. Goal Setting

1. Filling the Performance Appraisal Form

- a. On receipt of the Performance Appraisal Form the employee will fill in the Personal Details and list down the Key Result Areas.
- b. The individual employee will appraise him/ herself, on the given dimensions. This is to provide the employee with a chance to state without any inhibition/ reservation, his/ her achievements and areas of improvement. The employee should have a rationale for his self-assessment.

- c. The Appraiser will review the above assessment and based on his own observations rate the employee. In case the supervisor disagrees with the self-rating given by the employee, then the Appraiser will give a rationale in writing for the difference in opinion.
- d. Discussions shall be held between the employee and the Supervisor for Career Planning, Identification of Training Needs, and Job Rotation etc.
- e. The Performance Appraisal form will be forwarded to the Human Resource Department by the Appraiser for calculating the consolidated final ratings.
- f. Human Resource Department after calculating the Consolidated Rating shall submit proposal to the Reviewer /Approving Authority. The Reviewer /Approving Authority shall then decide the Future course of action to be taken in terms of Increments, Promotion, Transfer, Training etc.

The Performance Appraisal Form must be compulsorily returned to the Human Resource Department within 10 days of receipt of the form.

- 2. No overwriting or cutting of entries will be acceptable.
- 3. The whole appraisal system is based on a very comprehensive and exhaustive understanding of the role and contributions by the Appraisee. The Appraiser must be forthright, frank, unbiased, impartial and unguided by solo incidents during the review period. There must be true understanding between the Appraiser and the Appraisee on their respective roles.
- 4. The Human Resource Department shall be responsible for the successful implementation of the Performance Management Process. Towards this end it

will organize training for and hence facilitate Line Managers and staff conducting the Performance Appraisal Process with the right kind of attitude, stance, and accuracy and last but not the least the sensitivity that it deserves.

.....
MRS. ROBERTA J. KORYO ANKAMAH
(CHAIRMAN, HR SUB-COMMITTEE)

.....
DR. ERNEST OBUOBISA-DARKO
(BOARD CHAIRPERSON)

.....
MR. EMMANUEL EPHRAIM ARKOH
(HEAD, HUMAN RESOURCE)

.....
MR KINGSLEY KYERE
(CHIEF EXECUTIVE OFFICER)

ACKNOWLEDGMENT OF HR POLICY FOR STAFF

I acknowledge that I have received a copy of the **HR POLICY AND PROCEDURE MANUAL** for Staff, which outlines many of the guidelines and company procedures for employees. I understand that I will be responsible for all the information that it contains. I understand that the guidelines and procedures presented may not be inclusive and may be subject at any time to change or revocation at the sole discretion of the Bank.

I also understand that violation of any of the rules and regulations set forth in this policy can subject me to disciplinary action or immediate termination of employment. Since the information in this policy is subject to revision, it is understood that any policy changes supersede or eliminate the policies listed in the handbook.

I understand that if I have any questions, that I may have them clarified by my Head of Department or the Human Resources Manager.

EMPLOYEE'S NAME:

POSITION:

SIGNATURE:

DATE: